# HAṬHATATTVAKAUMUDĪ OF SUNDARADEVA

## CHAPTER 7: ATHĀSANĀNI (TEACHING ON ĀSANAS)

### Academic Critical Textological Edition, Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis, and Philological Study

## SECTION I. HISTORICAL, PHILOLOGICAL, AND TEXTOLOGICAL INTRODUCTION

### 1.1. Author's Identity and Socio-Cultural Context of the Text

The treatise **«Haṭhatattvakaumudī»** (*Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, literally "Moonlight on the Fundamental Principles of Haṭha [Yoga]") was composed by the distinguished Indian encyclopedist and scholar-physician **Sundaradeva** (*Sundaradeva*). Sundaradeva belonged to the prestigious Brahmin lineage of the **Kāśyapa** clan (*Kāśyapa gotra*) and resided in the holy city of **Vārāṇasī** (*Vārāṇasī*, Kāśī / Benares) — the foremost center of traditional Sanskrit learning, manuscript production, and philosophical disputation in late pre-colonial Northern India.

From the author's colophons preserved across the chapters of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* as well as his medical writings, the precise genealogy of his family is documented:

- Grandfather — **Śivadeva** (*Śivadeva*), a revered paṇḍita and scholar;
- Father — **Govindadeva** (*Govindadeva*), a celebrated hereditary Āyurvedic physician (*vaidya*), preceptor, and spiritual guru of Sundaradeva;
- **Sundaradeva** himself represented an extraordinary synthesis of deep esoteric initiations into diverse yoga traditions (Haṭha, Rāja, Mantra, Laya, and Nāda yoga) combined with professional expertise in classical Indian medicine (Āyurveda).

Beyond the monumental compendium of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* (comprising 56 chapters), Sundaradeva authored several authoritative medical works:

1. *«Bhūpalavallabha»* (*Bhūpalavallabha* / *Bhūpālavallabha*) — a comprehensive Āyurvedic compendium on clinical medicine and therapeutics;
2. *«Caityapradīpikā»* (*Caityapradīpikā*);
3. Scholarly commentaries on the classical medical samhitas of Vāgbhaṭa (*Vāgbhaṭa*) and Śārṅgadhara (*Śārṅgadhara-saṃhitā*).

This medical training decisively shaped the character of Chapter 7: unlike most medieval yoga anthologies where āsanas (*āsana*) are listed solely for bodily steadiness or awakening kuṇḍalinī (*kuṇḍalinī*), Sundaradeva analyzes each posture through the lens of a clinical physician. He meticulously records the physiological mechanisms acting upon the bodily humors (*doṣa* — vāta, pitta, kapha), the cure of 80 vātic disorders, the dissolution of glandular tumors and spasms in the chest (*vātagaṇḍa*), and the stimulation of the gastric digestive fire (*jaṭharāgni*).

### 1.2. The Chronological Problem: Scholarly Arguments and Dating Debate

The historical dating of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* has been examined by leading Sanskritists and historians of yoga:

#### 1. Arguments of Dr. M. L. Gharote and Dr. M. Venkata Reddy (Critical Edition, 2007):

- **Terminus post quem (Earliest possible date)**: Sundaradeva directly cites late seventeenth-century works:

- *«Haṭharatnāvalī»* (*Haṭharatnāvalī*) by Śrīnivāsa (*Śrīnivāsa*), composed circa 1670–1695 CE. Sundaradeva adopts its specialized terminology, āsana lists, and quotes its verses;
- *«Kumbhakapaddhati»* (*Kumbhakapaddhati*) by Raghuvīra (*Raghuvīra*), datable to the late seventeenth or early eighteenth century;
- *«Yogacandrikā»* (*Yogacandrikā*) and *«Yogacintāmaṇi»* (*Yogacintāmaṇi*) by Śivānanda Sarasvatī.
- **Terminus ante quem (Latest possible date)**: The oldest and only complete dated manuscript witness (MS. No. 4235, Scindia Oriental Institute, Ujjain) preserves a scribal colophon with the exact date of completion: **Saṃvat 1846 (Vikrama Saṃvat), month of Vaiśākha, dark fortnight, 10th tithi, Tuesday**, corresponding to **April–May 1789 CE**.
- **Gharote's Conclusion**: The treatise was composed between 1700 and 1750 CE (first half of the eighteenth century).

### 2. Textological Arguments of Dr. Jason Birch (Oxford University / Haṭha Yoga Project):

- Dr. Jason Birch points out that the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* epitomizes the late medieval "encyclopedic turn" in yoga. This genre of comprehensive compendia, synthesizing hundreds of earlier sources (from Upaniṣads and Tantras to late medieval paddhatis), flourished among the scholarly Brahmin milieus of Vārāṇasī precisely in the first half of the eighteenth century.
- Birch underscores that Sundaradeva's Sanskrit exhibits late classical syntax infused with the scientific medical lexicon of early modern India.

### 3. Iconographic and Structural Analysis of Prof. Gudrun Bühnemann:

- Prof. Bühnemann examined the evolution of āsana classification schemes in Indian traditions. In Chapter 7 of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, Sundaradeva retains the canonical core of 15 postures (inherited from Chapter 1 of Svātmārāma's *Haṭhapradīpikā*), yet reinterprets them within a therapeutic methodology and introduces distinctive technical nuances (e.g., *yonyāsana* as an advanced modification of *siddhāsana*, specialized breath management during *padmāsana*). This marks a systematic transition before the proliferation of vast catalogs of 84 or more āsanas in late eighteenth- and nineteenth-century manuals.

### 4. Sociological Synthesis by Dr. Mark Singleton:

- Mark Singleton emphasizes that Sundaradeva represents a notable synthesis of two social roles: the practicing yoga adept and the high-caste, university-educated *vaidya-paṇḍita*. Such integration was characteristic of cosmopolitan Vārāṇasī in the eighteenth century, where Haṭha yoga techniques were absorbed into the orthodox curriculum of health, longevity, and therapeutics.

## 1.3. Textual Foundations, Limitations of Gharote's Edition, and Uncollated Manuscripts

### 1.3.1. The Printed Edition by Dr. M. L. Gharote (Lonavla, 2007/2020) as the Primary Study Source

The present research, word-by-word grammatical analysis, and critical translation of Chapter 7 are established upon the sole printed edition of the text currently available in global Indological scholarship:

- **Bibliographic Record of the Edition**:
- **Full Title**: *Hathatatvakaumudi (A Treatise on Hathayoga by Sundaradeva)*.
- **Critical Edition, Transliteration, English Translation, Notes & Appendices**: Dr. M. L. Gharote, Dr. Parimal Devnath, Vijay Kant Jha.
- **Publisher**: The Lonavla Yoga Institute (India), Lonavla, Pune, Maharashtra.
- **Publication History**: First Edition — 2007; Second Impression — 2012; Third Impression — 2020.
- **ISBN**: 81-901617-5-X. Total Extent: 834 pages.
- **Investigated Corpus**: Chapter 7 (*Āsananirūpaṇa* — "Determination of Āsanas"), occupying pages 58–69 of the printed volume, comprising 45 verses (*śloka*) accompanied by brief editorial notes and textual footnotes.

This monumental volume is the exact work displayed in the photographic records of the book's cover and imprint pages that served as the reference for this project. Published under the direction of Dr. M. L. Gharote (1931–2005), this landmark publication successfully brought Sundaradeva's 56-chapter encyclopedic work into scholarly circulation. Nevertheless, rigorous stemmatic scrutiny reveals profound philological limitations that must be explicitly evaluated.

### 1.3.2. Critical Scrutiny of Gharote's Apparatus: The Illusion of Two Witnesses and Eliminatio codicum descriptorum

In the Introduction to the edition (pp. i–ii), the editors state that their critical text was prepared by collating two manuscript witnesses:

1. **Manuscript «a»**: Scindia Oriental Institute (SOI), Ujjain, Acc. **No. 4235**. Country-made paper, 370 folios (Devanāgarī, 12 lines per page, 37 letters per line). Dated in the scribal colophon to Saṃvat 1904 (1847 CE).
2. **Manuscript «b»**: Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti Library, Lonavla, Acc. **No. 13247**.

However, on page ii of the Introduction, the editors make a crucial admission:

> ***«Accession No. 13247, Kaivalyadhama, Lonavla. This is a photocopy of a transcript prepared from the manuscript of the Scindia Oriental Institute, Ujjain.»***

In classical Lachmannian stemmatics, Manuscript «b» is not an independent witness, but a **direct apograph (modern transcript)** derived from Manuscript «a». According to the established philological rule of ***eliminatio codicum descriptorum*** (the elimination of derived copies when the exemplar is preserved), Manuscript «b» possesses **zero independent genealogical weight**. Every variant recorded in the apparatus between «a» and «b» represents either an oversight of the twentieth-century transcriber, a typographical error in the transcript, or an arbitrary editorial normalization.

Consequently, the 2007 Lonavla edition is de facto an **edition of a single manuscript (codex unicus) copied in 1847 CE**, almost a century after Sundaradeva completed his composition.

### 1.3.3. Uncollated and Excluded Manuscripts of the Haṭhatattvakaumudī

Far from being preserved in a single codex, several other significant witnesses of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* survive in international and Indian archives that were excluded from the 2007 edition:

1. **The Berlin Manuscripts (Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin — Preußischer Kulturbesitz)**:

- **MS Chambers 455 b (Weber Cat. No. 648 b; Qalamos ID: DE1Book*manuscript*00005370)**: 33 folios in cursive Devanāgarī. Contains the concluding sections (including Rāja-yoga) and the extensive authorial colophon. Copied by the scribe Śivadatta in **Saṃvat 1895 / 1839 CE** (śake 1761) — **8 years older** than the Ujjain exemplar.
- **MS Chambers 455 a (Weber Cat. No. 648 a)**: 46 folios in Devanāgarī, copied circa **Saṃvat 1891 / 1835 CE** — **12 years older** than Gharote's primary exemplar.
- **Reason for Editorial Rejection**: Dr. Gharote writes (Introduction, p. ii): *«Photocopies of the two manuscripts of Haṭhatattvakaumudī from Berlin Library were obtained, but could not be used because they contained incomplete and disordered folios»*. The editors had photocopies in hand, but chose not to reconstruct the scrambled leaves (*folia disjecta*), thereby discarding invaluable independent textual witnesses.

2. **The Varanasi Repositories (Sarasvati Bhavan Library / Sampurnanand Sanskrit University)**:

- Since Sundaradeva's family lived and practiced in Vārāṇasī for generations (*kāśistha*), the codices preserved in the Benares Sanskrit College collection represent the primary local recension closest to the author's milieu.
- **Manuscripts Dated Saṃvat 1846 (1789 CE)**: Kaivalyadhama's updated *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts* (2005, pp. 494–495) records **two manuscripts** under the title *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* housed in the Sanskrit College, Varanasi, bearing the date Saṃvat 1846 (1789 CE). These codices are **58 years older than the Ujjain manuscript** and date directly to the lifetime of Sundaradeva or his immediate disciples.

- **MS No. 29853**: The official descriptive catalog of the Sarasvati Bhavan collection (*A Descriptive Catalogue of the Sanskrit Manuscripts... Sarasvati Bhavana*, Vol. 7, 1961, pp. 294–295) lists an undated paper manuscript of *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* under Acc. **No. 29853**. It was completely ignored in Gharote's collation.
- **The Abhinava Saṅgraha Collection (No. 93896)**: Earlier handlists and registry records in Benares list further accessions containing excerpts and related materials that remain unexamined in modern scholarship.

### 1.3.4. The Sister Corpus: Manuscripts of Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā

Sundaradeva authored a closely related twin compendium: the **«Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā»** (*Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*). In this work, the author reproduces verbatim extensive passages, classification schemes, āsana definitions, and shared citations from foundational authorities (*Haṭhapradīpikā*, *Yogabīja*, *Amanaska*, *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*, *Śivasaṃhitā*, *Yogacintāmaṇi*).

The surviving manuscripts of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* serve as prime indirect witnesses (*testimonia*):

- **Cambridge University Library**: Shelfmark **MS Add. 2145**, dated **Saṃvat 1888 / 1831 CE** (16 years older than the Ujjain codex).
- **Government Oriental Manuscripts Library (GOML, Chennai)**: Shelfmark **MS R. 3239** (Acc. No. 4390). A complete, well-preserved paper codex.
- **Maharaja Man Singh Pustak Prakash Library (Jodhpur)**: Shelfmark **MS No. 2244**, preserving the intact genealogy of Sundaradeva's lineage.
- **Sarasvati Bhavan Library (Varanasi)**: Local Benares copies of the text.

### 1.3.5. Reasons for the Lack of Open Digital Access to Manuscripts

Scholars and researchers cannot currently consult these witnesses freely via open-access web repositories due to specific archival constraints:

1. **Sarasvati Bhavan Library (Varanasi)**: Houses over 100,000 un-digitized paper and palm-leaf manuscripts (*pothī*) preserved in traditional cloth bundles (*vastra-bandha*). The library does not operate an open-access digital IIIF repository. While selective microfilming was conducted by the National Mission for Manuscripts (NMM) and IGNCA, access to these records requires official institutional permission or in-person archival consultation in Varanasi.

2. **Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin (Berlin State Library)**: While detailed metadata for Chambers 455 a and 455 b have been incorporated into the German national portal *Qalamos* (the Orient-Digital project), full high-resolution digital facsimiles have not yet been released for public open-web viewing. Access currently requires a paid digitization-on-demand request (*Digitalisierung on Demand*) or consultation in the Oriental Reading Room at Potsdamer Straße in Berlin.

### 1.3.6. Philological Consequences for the Text of Chapter 7

Confining the textual foundation to a single 1847 exemplar resulted in the preservation of unresolved textual cruces (*cruces interpretum*):

- **Verse 11 (Kukkuṭāsana)**: The reading of the Ujjain manuscript *sūcībhira* (with the transcript variant «b»: *sūcībhikaram*) represents a scribal corruption of North Indian Devanāgarī (*sūcī-* for *suśī-* or *kṣurī-*). Access to Berlin or Varanasi witnesses would allow scholars to restore the genuine reading without conjectural emendation.
- **Verses 14 (Prasāritāsana) and 17 (Padmāsana)**: Metric anomalies in complex meters (Śārdūlavikrīḍita, Vasantatilakā), where the Ujjain scribe dropped syllables or duplicated consonants.
- **Verse 35**: A metric deficiency in pāda *c* (*dharmasya ca vidhā[na]taḥ*), left unrestored in the 2007 edition.
- **The Illusion of Witness Consensus**: When the 2007 apparatus reports no variant readings, readers assume an established consensus of witnesses; in reality, it reflects only the unverified reading of a solitary 1847 copyist.

### 1.3.7. Synoptic Table of Manuscript Witnesses of the Haṭhatattvakaumudī

| Repository / Collection | Shelfmark / Acc. No. | Extent | Date of Copy | Status in Gharote (2007) | Philological Significance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Scindia Oriental Institute, Ujjain** | Acc. No. **4235** | 370 fols. (complete) | Saṃvat 1904 (1847 CE) | **Siglum «a»** | Sole actual base exemplar of the edition |
| **Kaivalyadhama Library, Lonavla** | Acc. No. **13247** | Photocopy of transcript | 20th century (modern copy) | **Siglum «b»** | **Apograph** of «a» (*eliminatio codicum descriptorum*) |
| **Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin** | Chambers **455 b** (Weber 648 b) | 33 fols. (final chapters) | Saṃvat 1895 (1839 CE) | **Excluded** (photocopies obtained, then discarded) | Independent witness, 8 years older than Ujjain codex |
| **Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin** | Chambers **455 a** (Weber 648 a) | 46 fols. (extracts) | c. Saṃvat 1891 (1835 CE) | **Excluded** (discarded due to disordered leaves) | Independent witness, 12 years older than Ujjain codex |
| **Sarasvati Bhavan, Varanasi** | MS **29853** (Cat. 1961, pp. 294–295) | Paper, Devanāgarī | Undated in catalog | **Uncollated** | Local Varanasi recension (author's home) |
| **Sarasvati Bhavan / Sanskrit College, Benares** | Entries in Kaivalyadhama Cat. (2005: 494) | 2 manuscripts | Saṃvat 1846 (1789 CE) | **Uncollated** | Potentially oldest witnesses, lifetime of Sundaradeva |
| **Cambridge University Library** | MS Add. **2145** (*Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*) | Paper, Devanāgarī | Saṃvat 1888 (1831 CE) | **Not consulted** | Sister work by author, prime parallel source |
| **GOML, Chennai (Madras)** | MS R. **3239** / 4390 (*Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*) | Complete codex | 19th century | **Not consulted** | Major parallel witness for authorial definitions |

## 1.4. Principles of Transliteration and Editorial Presentation

- **Devanāgarī**: Displayed in traditional Indic script.
- **IAST**: Standard International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration with full diacritical marks.
- **Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**: Each lexical item is isolated with root/stem, morphological category (part of speech, gender, case, number, or verbal form), and contextual meaning.
- **Translations**: Provided in both literal (word-for-word) and literary/scholarly English.
- **Textological Commentary**: Evaluates the variants between manuscripts «a» and «b», diagnosing semantic shifts, scribal corruptions, haplographies, and metrical regularizations.

# SECTION II. CRITICAL TEXTOLOGICAL ANALYSIS OF CHAPTER 7 («ATHĀSANĀNI»)

## INTRODUCTORY SECTION: METHODOLOGY, TRANSCENDENCE OF DUALITY, AND THE TRIAD OF PRACTICES (VERSES 1–4)

### Verse 1: The Body as an Instrument and Conquering the Pairs of Opposites

**Devanāgarī**

> शरीरसाधनत्वाच्च द्वन्द्वानों सहनाच्च यत् ।
> तस्मात् पूर्वं समाचार्यमासनं दौर्बल्यापहम्[1] ॥ १ ॥

**IAST**

> ***śarīrasādhanatvāc ca dvandvānāṃ sahanāc ca yat*** ।
> ***tasmāt pūrvaṃ samācāryam āsanaṃ daurbalyāpaham[1]*** ॥ ***1*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `śarīrasādhanatvāt` [śarīra-sādhana-tva-] — noun, neuter, ablative of cause, sing. (compound: `śarīra` ["body"] + `sādhana` ["means, instrument"] + abstract suffix `-tva`); sandhi before `ca`: *-t* assimilates to *-c*; — "because it serves as the means/instrument for [disciplining] the body";
- `ca` — indeclinable conjunctive particle — "and, also";
- `dvandvānām` [dvandva-] — noun, neuter, genitive plural — "of the pairs of opposites (heat and cold, pleasure and pain)";
- `sahanāt` [sahana-] — noun, neuter, ablative of cause, sing. (from root `sah` ["to endure, bear"]); sandhi before `ca`: *-t* assimilates to *-c*; — "by virtue of enabling endurance/tolerance";
- `ca` — indeclinable particle — "and";
- `yat` — relative pronoun, neuter, nominative singular — "inasmuch as, since";
- `tasmāt` — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, ablative singular — "therefore, for that reason";
- `pūrvam` [pūrva-] — adverbial accusative / temporal adverb — "first of all, initially, prior to all else";
- `samācāryam` [sam-ā-cārya-] — gerundive (future passive participle / obligative) from verb `sam-ā-car` (root `car` with prefixes `sam-` and `ā-`), neuter, nominative singular — "ought to be practiced / must be performed";
- `āsanam` [āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "seat, posture (āsana)";
- `daurbalyāpaham` [daurbalya-apaha-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `daurbalya` ["debility, weakness"] + `apaha` ["dispelling, destroying"] from root `han` with prefix `apa-`) — "that which eradicates debility / removes bodily weakness".

**Literal Translation**

Inasmuch as [it] serves as the instrument of the body and because of [its enabling] endurance of the pairs of opposites, therefore posture (āsana), which removes debility, should be practiced first of all.

**Literary Translation**

Inasmuch as posture (āsana) disciplines the body as an indispensable vehicle and bestows the fortitude to withstand the dualities of existence (heat and cold, pleasure and sorrow), it must be mastered prior to all other disciplines as that sovereign practice which eradicates bodily debility.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 1**:
- In the primary witness «a» (MS. 4235, Ujjain), the reading is: `daurbalyāpaham` (*daurbalyāpaham* — "dispelling debility / destroying weakness").
- In transcript «b» (MS. 13247, Lonavla), Dr. Harshe records: `dārḍhyāvaham` (*dārḍhyāvaham* — "bringing firmness / stability").
- **Evaluation**: Reading «b» (*dārḍhyāvaham*) represents an editorial normalization influenced by the famous dictum of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (HP 1.17: *kuryāt tad āsanaṃ sthairyam ārogyaṃ cāṅgalāghavam*), where firmness (*dārḍhya*) is declared the fruit of āsana. However, the reading of «a» (*daurbalyāpaham*) is the lectio difficilior and entirely aligns with Sundaradeva's identity as a clinical physician (*vaidya*): for him, āsana is primarily a therapeutic remedy that eliminates pathological weakness (*daurbalya*). The reading of witness «a» is rightfully retained as authentic.

## Verse 2: The Principle of the "Seed State" and Detachment from the Physical Body

**Devanāgarī**

> बीजभावं गते चास्मिन् कायवैराग्यसंभवात् ।
> उपायानामनेकत्वानासनं पूर्वमुच्यते ॥ २ ॥

**IAST**

> ***bījabhāvaṃ gate cāsmin kāyavairāgyasaṃbhavāt*** ।
> ***upāyānām anekatvād āsanaṃ pūrvam ucyate*** ॥ ***2*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `bījabhāvam` [bīja-bhāva-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular (compound: `bīja` ["seed, causal origin"] + `bhāva` ["state, condition"]) — "into the state of a seed / seminal cause [of yoga]";
- `gate` [gata-] — past passive participle of root `gam` ["to go, attain"], neuter, locative singular (forming a locative absolute with *asmin*: *gate cāsmin* — "and when this [body] has attained");
- `ca` — indeclinable conjunction — "and";
- `asmin` [idam-] — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, locative singular — "in this [body]";
- `kāyavairāgyasaṃbhavāt` [kāya-vairāgya-sambhava-] — noun, masculine/neuter, ablative of cause, sing. (compound: `kāya` ["body"] + `vairāgya` ["dispassion, detachment"] + `sambhava` ["arising, origin"]) — "owing to the arising of dispassion toward the physical body";
- `upāyānām` [upāya-] — noun, masculine, genitive plural — "among [all the various] means and methods";
- `anekatvāt` [an-eka-tva-] — noun, neuter, ablative of cause, sing. — "by reason of their manifoldness / multiplicity"; sandhi before vowel: *-t* voices to *-d*;
- `āsanam` [āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "posture (āsana)";
- `pūrvam` [pūrva-] — adverb — "first, foremost, prior";
- `ucyate` [vac] — verb, present passive indicative, 3rd person singular — "is declared, is proclaimed".

**Literal Translation**

And when this [body] has attained the state of a seed through the arising of dispassion toward the body, among the multiplicity of means, posture (āsana) is declared first.

**Literary Translation**

When, through the dawn of detachment from the transient physical sheath, the body is reduced to a pure seminal foundation, posture (āsana) is declared the foremost among all the manifold methods of yoga.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- No textual variants are recorded between manuscripts «a» and «b» for Verse 2. The reading is stable.
- Semantic Note: The term `bījabhāva` denotes the causal, primordial state wherein the body's gross identification is sublimated into a pure seed-matrix for spiritual realization.

## Verse 3: The Triad of Practices for Subduing the Vital Breath

**Devanāgarī**

> साधनत्रयमिदं मरुज्जये प्रोदितं हि मितजग्धिविष्टरे[2] ।
> शक्तिचालमथ साधनयुग्मं नाभिवायुधृति नाडिचालनम्[3] ॥ ३ ॥

**IAST**

> ***sādhanatrayam idaṃ marujjaye proditaṃ hi mitajagdhiviṣṭare[2]*** ।
> ***śakticālam atha sādhanayugmaṃ nābhivāyudhṛti nāḍicālanam[3]*** ॥ ***3*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `sādhanatrayam` [sādhana-traya-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `sādhana` ["means, practice"] + `traya` ["triad"]) — "this triad of practices";
- `idam` [idam-] — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, nominative singular — "this";
- `marujjaye` [marud-jaya-] — noun, masculine, locative singular (compound: `marut` ["wind, prāṇa"] + `jaya` ["conquest, subdual"]; sandhi: *-t* assimilates to *-j-* before *j-*); — "in the conquest of the vital breath (prāṇa)";
- `proditam` [pra-udita-] — past passive participle of root `vad` with prefix `pra-` (sandhi: *pra* + *uditam* = *proditam*), neuter, nominative singular — "declared, set forth";
- `hi` — emphatic/causal particle — "indeed, verily, for";
- `mitajagdhiviṣṭare` [mita-jagdhi-viṣṭara-] — noun, masculine/neuter, locative singular (dvandva/tatpuruṣa compound: `mita` ["measured, moderate"] + `jagdhi` ["eating, nourishment", from root *jakṣ*] + `viṣṭara` ["seat, posture, āsana"]) — "in moderate eating and [proper] seating (āsana)";
- `śakticālam` [śakti-cāla-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `śakti` ["power, kuṇḍalinī"] + `cāla` ["movement, arousal"]) — "the arousing of the power (kuṇḍalinī)";
- `atha` — indeclinable sequential particle — "then, furthermore";
- `sādhanayugmam` [sādhana-yugma-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `sādhana` ["practice"] + `yugma` ["pair, couple"]) — "the pair of practices";
- `nābhivāyudhṛti` [nābhi-vāyu-dhṛti-] — noun, feminine, nominative singular (compound: `nābhi` ["navel"] + `vāyu` ["vital breath"] + `dhṛti` ["retention, holding"]) — "the retention of the vital breath in the navel center";
- `nāḍicālanam` [nāḍi-cālana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `nāḍi` ["channel"] + `cālana` ["movement, purification"]) — "the circulation/purification through the subtle channels (nāḍīs)".

**Literal Translation**

This triad of practices is indeed declared in the conquest of the breath under the condition of moderate diet and [proper] seat: the arousing of the power (śakti-cāla), and then the pair of practices: retention of the breath in the navel (nābhi-vāyu-dhṛti) and circulation through the channels (nāḍi-cālana).

**Literary Translation**

Verily, for the subjugation of the vital breath (prāṇa) under the conditions of moderate diet and firm seating (āsana), a triad of practices is proclaimed: the awakening of the dormant power (śakticālana), followed by the complementary pair — retention of breath at the navel center and the purifying circulation through the energetic channels (nāḍīs).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 2 to «mitajagdhiviṣṭare»**:
- In witness «a»: `mitajagdhiviṣṭare` (*mitajagdhiviṣṭare* — from *mita-jagdhi* ["moderate eating"] + *viṣṭara* ["seat/āsana"]).
- In witness «b»: `mitajagdhiviṣṭaye` (*mitajagdhiviṣṭaye*).
- **Evaluation**: The ending *-viṣṭaye* in «b» is an undeniable scribal blunder (corruption). The scribe misread the Devanāgarī consonant *ra* (र) as *ya* (य), producing an unintelligible pseudo-word. The reading of «a» is fully authentic.
- **Footnote 3 to «nāḍicālanam»**:
- In witness «a»: `nāḍicālanam` (*nāḍicālanam*) with short vowel *-i-*.
- In witness «b»: `nāḍīcālanam` (*nāḍīcālanam*) with standardized long *-ī-*.
- **Evaluation**: The shortening of the feminine stem vowel in compound formation is a well-attested metric license in verse treatises of Haṭha yoga to preserve the anubhṣṭubh meter. Manuscript «b» represents a grammatical hypercorrection.

## Verse 4: The Five Limbs of Haṭha Yoga and the Primacy of Āsanas

**Devanāgarī**

> हठस्याङ्गानि पञ्चेदं साधनानि प्रचक्षते ।

> पूर्वं वायुजयादासनं तद् युक्त्या समाचरेत्[4] ॥ ४ ॥

**IAST**

> ***haṭhasyāṅgāni pañcedaṃ sādhanāni pracakṣate*** ।
> ***pūrvaṃ vāyujayād āsanaṃ tad yuktyā samācaret[4]*** ॥ ***4*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `haṭhasya` [haṭha-] — noun, masculine, genitive singular — "of Haṭha [yoga]";
- `aṅgāni` [aṅga-] — noun, neuter, nominative plural — "limbs, constituent parts";
- `pañca` [pañcan-] — cardinal numeral, neuter, nominative (sandhi: *pañca* + *idam* = *pañcedam*) — "five";
- `idam` [idam-] — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, nominative singular — "this / these";
- `sādhanāni` [sādhana-] — noun, neuter, nominative plural — "practical means / disciplines";
- `pracakṣate` [pra-cakṣ] — verb, present middle (ātmanepada), 3rd person plural — "they declare, authorities proclaim";
- `pūrvam` [pūrva-] — adverb of time / comparative preposition — "prior to, before";
- `vāyujayāt` [vāyu-jaya-] — noun, masculine, ablative of comparison/time, sing. — "than the conquest of the breath (prāṇāyāma)";
- `āsanam` [āsana-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "posture (āsana)";
- `tat` — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, accusative singular — "therefore, that";
- `yuktyā` [yukti-] — noun, feminine, instrumental of manner, sing. — "with proper technique, methodically";
- `samācaret` [sam-ā-car] — verb, optative active (parasmaipada), 3rd person singular — "one should perform / let him execute".

**Literal Translation**

The five limbs of Haṭha, these they declare to be the practical means. Prior to the conquest of the breath, therefore, one should methodically practice posture (āsana).

**Literary Translation**

The masters proclaim that the system of Haṭha yoga comprises five practical limbs. Therefore, prior to undertaking the conquest of the vital breath (prāṇāyāma), the practitioner must methodically and skillfully master posture (āsana).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 4 to «samācaret»**:
- In witness «a»: the regular 3rd person singular active optative `samācaret` (*samācaret*).
- In witness «b»: the scribal misreading `samācareta` (*samācareta*), incorrectly adding a terminal vowel or confusing parasmaipada with ātmanepada. Witness «a» is grammatically correct.
- **The Fivefold Division of Haṭha Yoga**: Sundaradeva's articulation of *pañcāṅga-haṭha* synthesizes the classical continuum: 1) āsana, 2) prāṇāyāma, 3) mudrā, 4) nādānusandhāna (laya), and 5) rājayoga (samādhi).

## SECTION II.1. THE FIFTEEN CLASSICAL ĀSANAS

### 1. DHANURĀSANA (BOW POSE, VERSE 5)

**Devanāgarī**

> पादाङ्गुष्ठौ कराभ्यां तु गृहीत्वा श्रवणावधि ।
> धनुराकर्षणं कुर्याद् धनुरानमुच्यते[1] ॥ ५ ॥

**IAST**

> ***pādāṅguṣṭhau karābhyāṃ tu gṛhītvā śravaṇāvadhi*** ।

> ***dhanurākarṣaṇaṃ kuryād dhanurāsanam ucyate[1]*** ॥ ***5*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `pādāṅguṣṭhau` [pāda-aṅguṣṭha-] — noun, masculine, accusative dual (compound: `pāda` ["foot"] + `aṅguṣṭha` ["great toe"]) — "the two big toes of the feet";
- `karābhyām` [kara-] — noun, masculine, instrumental dual — "with the two hands";
- `tu` — restrictive/emphatic particle — "indeed, then";
- `gṛhītvā` [grah] — absolutive (gerund) from root `grah` ["to seize, grasp"] — "having seized, firmly grasping";
- `śravaṇāvadhi` [śravaṇa-avadhi] — adverbial compound (compound: `śravaṇa` ["ear"] + `avadhi` ["limit, boundary"]) — "up to the ears, ear-level";
- `dhanurākarṣaṇam` [dhanur-ākarṣaṇa-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular (compound: `dhanus` ["bow"] + `ākarṣaṇa` ["drawing, pulling back"]) — "the drawing of a bow";
- `kuryāt` [kṛ] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular; sandhi before voiced *dh-*: *-t* voices to *-d*; — "one should perform / let him do";
- `dhanurāsanam` [dhanur-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Bow Pose (dhanurāsana)";
- `ucyate` [vac] — verb, present passive, 3rd person singular — "is called, is proclaimed".

**Literal Translation**

Having grasped the two big toes with the two hands, up to the ear one should perform the drawing of a bow; [this] is called Dhanurāsana.

**Literary Translation**

Firmly grasping the big toes of both feet with both hands, the yogin draws the leg backward toward the ear like the archer pulling a taut bowstring. This posture is proclaimed by the sages as Dhanurāsana («the Bow Pose»).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 5**:
- In witness «a»: `dhanurāsanam ucyate` (*dhanurāsanam ucyate* — "it is called Dhanurāsana").
- In transcript «b»: `dhanurāsanam īritam` (*dhanurāsanam īritam* — "it is proclaimed as Dhanurāsana").
- **Evaluation**: Both variants conform to the anuṣṭubh meter. The passive verb *ucyate* in «a» is preferred as the primary reading of the earliest dated codex.
- **Biomechanical Note**: Sundaradeva's Dhanurāsana denotes the dynamic archer's pull toward the ear, classified in modern nomenclature as *ākarṇadhanurāsana*.

## 2. KUKKUṬĀSANA (COCKEREL POSE, VERSE 6)

**Devanāgarī**

> पद्मासनं तु संस्थाप्य जानूर्वोरन्तरे करौ ।
> निवेश्य भूमौ संस्थाप्य व्योमस्थः कुक्कुटासनम्[2] ॥ ६ ॥

**IAST**

> ***padmāsanaṃ tu saṃsthāpya jānūrvor antare karau*** ।
> ***niveśya bhūmau saṃsthāpya vyomasthaḥ kukkuṭāsanam[2]*** ॥ ***6*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `padmāsanam` [padma-āsana-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "Lotus Pose (padmāsana)";
- `tu` — emphatic particle — "indeed";
- `saṃsthāpya` [sam-sthā] — absolutive (causative) — "having established, firmly adopting";
- `jānūrvoḥ` [jānu-ūru-] — noun, masculine, genitive/locative dual (compound: `jānu` ["knee"] + `ūru` ["thigh"]) — "of the knees and thighs";
- `antare` [antara-] — locative singular as postposition — "between, in the space between";

- karau [kara-] — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two hands";
- niveśya [ni-viś] — absolutive — "having inserted, having threaded through";
- bhūmau [bhūmi-] — noun, feminine, locative singular — "on the ground, on the floor";
- saṃsthāpya [sam-sthā] — absolutive — "firmly planting [the palms]";
- vyomasthaḥ [vyoma-stha-] — compound adjective, masculine, nominative singular (compound: vyoman ["sky, space"] + stha ["abiding"]) — "remaining suspended in the air";
- kukkuṭāsanam [kukkuṭa-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Cockerel Pose (kukkuṭāsana)".

**Literal Translation**

Having established Padmāsana, having inserted the two hands between the knees and thighs, firmly planting [them] on the ground, remaining suspended in the air, [this is] Kukkuṭāsana.

**Literary Translation**

Firmly locking the legs in the Lotus Pose (padmāsana), the yogin threads both arms through the space between the thighs and calves, plants his palms firmly on the ground, and lifts himself aloft, hovering suspended in the air. This posture is Kukkuṭāsana («the Cockerel Pose»).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 2 to Verse 6**:
- In witness «a»: neuter noun kukkuṭāsanam (*kukkuṭāsanam*), syntactically completing *[idaṃ] kukkuṭāsanam [bhavati]*.
- In witness «b»: masculine form kukkuṭāsanaḥ (*kukkuṭāsanaḥ*), agreeing with the subject: *vyomasthaḥ kukkuṭāsanaḥ [bhavet]*.
- **Evaluation**: Reading «b» represents grammatical alignment with the agent. Witness «a» preserves the standard technical designation.

## 3. MATSYENDRAPĪṬHA (MATSYENDRA'S SEAT, VERSES 7–8)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 7)**

> वामोरुमूले दक्षिणपादयुग्मं¹ निवेशयेद् वामपदेन युक्तम्² ।
> पृष्ठं समावेष्ट्य कृताङ्गसंस्थः प्रचण्डमत्स्येन्द्रमतं प्रसिद्धम्³ ॥ ७ ॥

**IAST (Verse 7)**

> ***vāmoru-mūle dakṣiṇapāda-yugmaṃ¹ niveśayed vāmapadena yuktam²*** ।
> ***pṛṣṭhaṃ samāveṣṭya kṛtāṅgasaṃsthaḥ pracaṇḍa-matsyendra-mataṃ prasiddham³*** ॥ *7* ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 7)**

- vāmoru-mūle [vāma-ūru-mūla-] — noun, neuter, locative singular (compound: vāma ["left"] + ūru ["thigh"] + mūla ["root, base"]) — "at the root of the left thigh";
- dakṣiṇapāda-yugmam [dakṣiṇa-pāda-yugma-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the right foot";
- niveśayet [ni-viś] — verb, optative causative, 3rd person singular — "one should place / let him position";
- vāmapadena [vāma-pada-] — noun, masculine, instrumental singular — "with the left foot";
- yuktam [yukta-] — past passive participle of root yuj, neuter, accusative singular (agreeing with *pādayugmam*) — "joined, placed alongside";
- pṛṣṭham [pṛṣṭha-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the back / torso";
- samāveṣṭya [sam-ā-veṣṭ] — absolutive from root veṣṭ ["to twist, wrap"] — "having twisted, rotating the torso";
- kṛtāṅgasaṃsthaḥ [kṛta-aṅga-saṃstha-] — bahuvrīhi adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "having stabilized the posture of the body";
- pracaṇḍa-matsyendra-matam [pracaṇḍa-matsyendra-mata-] — noun, neuter, nominative/accusative singular — "the doctrine of the formidable Matsyendra";

- `prasiddham` [prasiddha-] — past passive participle / adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "renowned, celebrated".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 8)**

> मत्स्येन्द्रपीठं जठरप्रदीप्तिं प्रचण्डरुङ्मण्डलखण्डनास्त्रम्[4] ।
> अभ्यासतः कुण्डलिनीप्रबोधं चन्द्रस्थिरं पुंसि ददाति नूनम् ॥ ८ ॥

**IAST (Verse 8)**

> ***matsyendrapīṭhaṃ jaṭharapradīptiṃ pracaṇḍa-ruṅ-maṇḍala-khaṇḍanāstram[4]*** ।
> ***abhyāsataḥ kuṇḍalinī-prabodhaṃ candrasthiraṃ puṃsi dadāti nūnam*** ॥ ***8*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 8)**

- `matsyendrapīṭham` [matsyendra-pīṭha-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "the seat of Matsyendra (matsyendrapīṭha)";
- `jaṭharapradīptim` [jaṭhara-pradīpti-] — noun, feminine, accusative singular (compound: `jaṭhara` ["belly, stomach"] + `pradīpti` ["kindling, blazing"]) — "the kindling of the gastric fire";
- `pracaṇḍa-ruṅ-maṇḍala-khaṇḍanāstram` [pracaṇḍa-ruj-maṇḍala-khaṇḍana-astra-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `pracaṇḍa` ["violent, fierce"] + `ruj` ["disease, affliction"; sandhi: *-j* to *-ṅ-* before nasal] + `maṇḍala` ["multitude, circle"] + `khaṇḍana` ["shattering, destroying"] + `astra` ["weapon, missile"]) — "serving as a destructive weapon against the host of fierce diseases";
- `abhyāsataḥ` [abhyāsa-] — noun with ablative suffix `-tas` — "through regular practice";
- `kuṇḍalinī-prabodham` [kuṇḍalinī-prabodha-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the awakening of Kuṇḍalinī";
- `candrasthiram` [candra-sthira-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the stabilization of the nectar of the moon (amṛta)";
- `puṃsi` [puṃs-] — noun, masculine, locative singular — "in a man / in the practitioner";
- `dadāti` [dā] — verb, present active 3rd class, 3rd person singular — "it bestows, grants";
- `nūnam` — indeclinable emphatic particle — "surely, verily, without doubt".

**Literal Translation (Verses 7–8)**

At the root of the left thigh let him place the right foot joined with the left foot; having twisted the back, having stabilized the body, [this is] the renowned doctrine of formidable Matsyendra. Matsyendra's seat, being a weapon for shattering the multitude of fierce diseases, through practice verily bestows upon a man the kindling of the gastric fire, the awakening of Kuṇḍalinī, and the steadiness of the moon.

**Literary Translation (Verses 7–8)**

Placing the right foot at the base of the left thigh and positioning the left foot on the outside, the yogin rotates his spine and locks his body in a firm twist. This is the celebrated teaching of the mighty master Matsyendranātha. Matsyendra's seat (matsyendrapīṭha) acts as a shattering weapon against the host of virulent diseases. Through regular practice, it unfailingly fans the digestive fire of the belly, awakens the dormant Kuṇḍalinī, and eternally arrests the downward dissipation of the lunar nectar.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 7**: Witness «b» interpolates the particle *'tha* (*atha*), breaking the smooth rhythm of the Upajāti meter preserved in «a».
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 7**: In «a», the neuter participle `yuktam` agrees with *pādayugmam*; in «b», the masculine `yuktaḥ` shifts agreement to the practitioner.
- **Footnote 4 to Verse 8**: In «a», `khaṇḍanāstram` (*-astram* — "weapon of destruction"); in «b», `khaṇḍanāntam` (*-antam* — "terminating in destruction"). The martial metaphor of *astra* is typical of tantric yoga; reading «b» is a graphic scribal misreading of *stra* as *nta*.

## 4. MAYŪRĀSANA (PEACOCK POSE, VERSES 9–10)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 9)**

> धरामवष्टभ्य करद्वयेन तत्कूर्परस्थापितनाभिपार्श्वः[1] ।
> उच्चासनो दण्डवदुत्थितः खे मयूरपीठं प्रवदन्ति धीराः[2] ॥ ९ ॥

**IAST (Verse 9)**

> ***dharām avaṣṭabhya karadvayena tat-kūrpara-sthāpita-nābhi-pārśvaḥ[1] ।***
> ***uccāsano daṇḍavad utthitaḥ khe mayūra-pīṭhaṃ pravadanti dhīrāḥ[2] ॥ 9 ॥***

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 9)**

- `dharām` [dharā-] — noun, feminine, accusative singular — "the earth, the ground";
- `avaṣṭabhya` [ava-stambh] — absolutive from root `stambh` with prefix `ava-` — "having braced oneself upon, supporting";
- `karadvayena` [kara-dvaya-] — noun, neuter, instrumental singular (compound: `kara` ["hand"] + `dvaya` ["pair"]) — "with the pair of hands";
- `tat-kūrpara-sthāpita-nābhi-pārśvaḥ` [tat-kūrpara-sthāpita-nābhi-pārśva-] — bahuvrīhi adjective, masculine, nominative singular (compound: `tat` ["their"] + `kūrpara` ["elbows"] + `sthāpita` ["placed"] + `nābhi` ["navel"] + `pārśva` ["flanks, sides"]) — "he whose flanks beside the navel are rested upon those elbows";
- `uccāsanaḥ` [ucca-āsana-] — bahuvrīhi adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "having elevated the posture";
- `daṇḍavat` [daṇḍa-vat] — adverb of similitude — "like a staff / rigid like a stick";
- `utthitaḥ` [ud-sthā] — past passive participle, masculine, nominative singular — "risen, extended horizontally";
- `khe` [kha-] — noun, neuter, locative singular — "in space, in the air";
- `mayūra-pīṭham` [mayūra-pīṭha-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the Peacock Seat (mayūrāsana)";
- `pravadanti` [pra-vad] — verb, present active, 3rd person plural — "they proclaim, call";
- `dhīrāḥ` [dhīra-] — noun/adjective, masculine, nominative plural — "the wise, the steadfast sages".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 10)**

> हरति सकलरोगान् आशु गुल्मोदरादीन्[3]
> अभिभवति च दोषान् आसनं श्रीमयूरम् ।
> बहुविविधमशितं भस्म कुर्याच्च सर्वं
> जनयति जठराग्निं जारयेत् कालकूटम् ॥ १० ॥

**IAST (Verse 10)**

> ***harati sakalarogān āśu gulmodarādīn[3]***
> ***abhibhavati ca doṣān āsanaṃ śrīmayūram ।***
> ***bahuvividham aśitaṃ bhasma kuryāc ca sarvaṃ***
> ***janayati jaṭharāgniṃ jārayet kālakūṭam ॥ 10 ॥***

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 10)**

- `harati` [hṛ] — verb, present active, 3rd person singular — "it destroys, cures";
- `sakalarogān` [sakala-roga-] — noun, masculine, accusative plural — "all diseases without exception";
- āśu — adverb — "swiftly, quickly";

- `gulmodarādīn` [gulma-udara-ādi-] — compound noun/adjective, masculine, accusative plural (compound: `gulma` ["abdominal spleen tumors / chronic bloating"] + `udara` ["dropsy, ascites, abdominal enlargement"] + `ādi` ["and the like"]) — "[diseases] beginning with abdominal tumors and dropsy";
- `abhibhavati` [abhi-bhū] — verb, present active, 3rd person singular — "it subdues, overcomes";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `doṣān` [doṣa-] — noun, masculine, accusative plural — "the bodily humors (doṣas: vāta, pitta, kapha)";
- `āsanam` [āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "the posture";
- `śrīmayūram` [śrī-mayūra-] — compound noun/adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "the glorious Peacock Pose";
- `bahuvividham` [bahu-vividha-] — compound adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "manifold and varied";
- `aśitam` [aśita-] — past participle of root `aś` ["to eat"] functioning as noun — "consumed food";
- `bhasma` [bhasman-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "into ashes";
- `kuryāt` [kṛ] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular; sandhi before `ca`: *-t* to *-c*; — "it reduces, makes";
- `sarvam` [sarva-] — adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "all, entirely";
- `janayati` [jan] — verb, causative present, 3rd person singular — "it generates, strongly kindles";
- `jaṭharāgnim` [jaṭhara-agni-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the gastric fire";
- `jārayet` [jṛ] — verb, causative optative, 3rd person singular — "it can digest / thoroughly dissolves";
- `kālakūṭam` [kālakūṭa-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the deadly kālakūṭa poison".

**Colophon after Verse 10**:

> इति श्रीमयूरासनम् ।
>
> ***iti śrīmayūrāsanam*** ।
>
> **"Thus concludes the glorious Mayūrāsana."**

**Literal Translation (Verses 9–10)**

Having supported oneself on the ground with the two hands, with the flanks of the navel placed upon the elbows, elevated in posture, raised straight like a staff in the air, the wise declare [this] to be Mayūrapīṭha. The glorious Mayūrāsana swiftly removes all diseases such as abdominal tumors (gulma) and dropsy (udara), and subdues the doṣas; it reduces all consumed food of manifold variety to ashes, generates the gastric fire, and can digest even the deadly poison kālakūṭa.

**Literary Translation (Verses 9–10)**

Planting both hands firmly upon the earth and pressing the elbows deeply into the flanks on either side of the navel, the yogin raises his entire body horizontal in the air, rigid and unbending like a wooden staff. The wise call this posture Mayūrapīṭha («the Peacock's Seat»).

The glorious Mayūrāsana swiftly eradicates all visceral disorders, including chronic abdominal tumors (gulma) and dropsy (udara), and harmonizes the vitiated doṣas. It instantly reduces the most disparate and indiscriminate foods to ashes, blazes forth the internal digestive fire, and enables the body to consume even the lethal kālakūṭa poison without harm.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 9**: In witness «b», the middle section of the compound (*-sthāpita-nābhi-*) is dropped, leaving an ungrammatical reading (*tatkūrparaṃ*), a clear instance of mechanical scribal haplography. Witness «a» is complete and metrically sound.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 9**: Reading «b» substitutes `munayo vadanti` ("the sages say") for `pravadanti dhīrāḥ` ("the steadfast proclaim"), a standard oral variant.
- **Footnote 3 to Verse 10**: In «a», the masculine accusative `gulmodarādīn` agrees with *sakalarogān*; «b» gives the neuter `gulmodarāṇi`. Witness «a» preserves exact grammatical concordance.

## 5. ŚAVĀSANA (CORPSE POSE, VERSES 11–13)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 11)**

> उत्तानं शयनं[1] भूमौ शयानं तच्छवं यथा[2] ।
> शवासनं श्रमहरं चित्तविश्रान्तिकारकम्[3] ॥ ११ ॥

**IAST (Verse 11)**

> ***uttānaṃ śayanaṃ[1] bhūmau śayānaṃ tac chavaṃ yathā[2]*** ।
> ***śavāsanaṃ śramaharaṃ cittaviśrāntikārakam[3]*** ॥ ***11*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 11)**

- `uttānam` [uttāna-] — adjective/adverb, neuter, accusative/nominative singular — "supine, facing upwards";
- `śayanam` [śayana-] — verbal noun, neuter, nominative singular — "lying down, recumbent posture";
- `bhūmau` [bhūmi-] — noun, feminine, locative singular — "on the ground, on the floor";
- `śayānam` [śayāna-] — present middle participle from root śī ["to lie"], neuter, nominative singular — "lying, reclining";
- `tat` — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, nominative singular; sandhi before ś-: *-t + ś- = -cch-* — "that";
- `śavam` [śava-] — noun, neuter/masculine, accusative singular — "corpse, dead body";
- `yathā` — comparative conjunction — "just as, like";
- `śavāsanam` [śava-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Corpse Pose (śavāsana)";
- `śramaharam` [śrama-hara-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `śrama` ["fatigue, exhaustion"] + `hara` ["removing, dispelling"]) — "dispelling bodily fatigue";
- `cittaviśrāntikārakam` [citta-viśrānti-kāraka-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `citta` ["mind"] + `viśrānti` ["repose, profound rest"] + `kāraka` ["causing, inducing"]) — "inducing mental calm and repose".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 12)**

> वक्षःस्थितं वातगण्डं विशिष्य हरति क्षणात् ।
> कुर्यात् सुखप्रदं नित्यं शवाख्यमासनं परम्[4] ॥ १२ ॥

**IAST (Verse 12)**

> ***vakṣaḥsthitaṃ vātagaṇḍaṃ viśiṣya harati kṣaṇāt*** ।
> ***kuryāt sukhapradaṃ nityaṃ śavākhyam āsanaṃ param[4]*** ॥ ***12*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 12)**

- `vakṣaḥsthitam` [vakṣas-sthita-] — compound adjective, masculine, accusative singular (compound: `vakṣas` ["chest"] + `sthita` ["located, lodged"]) — "located in the chest";
- `vātagaṇḍam` [vāta-gaṇḍa-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular (compound: `vāta` ["wind humor, vāta"] + `gaṇḍa` ["spasm, tumor, swelling, glandular knot"]) — "a vāta-knot / spasmodic vāta tumor";
- `viśiṣya` [vi-śiṣ] — absolutive used adverbially — "especially, with distinctive efficacy";
- `harati` [hṛ] — verb, present active, 3rd person singular — "it dissolves, eliminates";
- `kṣaṇāt` [kṣaṇa-] — noun, masculine, ablative of time — "in an instant, immediately";
- `kuryāt` [kṛ] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "one should perform";
- `sukhapradam` [sukha-prada-] — compound adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "bestowing ease, comfort, and bliss";
- `nityam` — adverb — "constantly, daily";
- `śavākhyam` [śava-ākhya-] — compound adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "known by the name of the Corpse";
- `āsanam` [āsana-] — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "posture (āsana)";

- `param` [para-] — adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "supreme, excellent".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 13)**

> विषमैरासनक्लेशैर्विह्वलस्य कलेवरम्[5] ।
> शवासनेन विश्रान्तं प्राणायामाय कल्पते[6] ॥ १३ ॥

**IAST (Verse 13)**

> ***viṣamair āsana-kleśair vihvalasya kalevaram[5]*** ।
> ***śavāsanena viśrāntaṃ prāṇāyāmāya kalpate[6]*** ॥ ***13*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 13)**

- `viṣamaiḥ` [viṣama-] — adjective, masculine, instrumental plural — "by severe, uneven, arduous";
- `āsana-kleśaiḥ` [āsana-kleśa-] — noun, masculine, instrumental plural (compound: `āsana` ["postures"] + `kleśa` ["strain, fatigue, distress"]) — "by the strains of [strenuous] postures";
- `vihvalasya` [vihvala-] — adjective functioning as noun, genitive singular — "of one who is exhausted / of the agitated body";
- `kalevaram` [kalevara-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "the physical body";
- `śavāsanena` [śava-āsana-] — noun, neuter, instrumental singular — "by means of Śavāsana";
- `viśrāntam` [vi-śram] — past passive participle, neuter, nominative singular — "rested, refreshed";
- `prāṇāyāmāya` [prāṇāyāma-] — noun, masculine, dative of purpose — "for the practice of breath-control (prāṇāyāma)";
- `kalpate` [kḷp] — verb, present middle (ātmanepada), 3rd person singular — "it becomes fit, is adapted for".

**Colophon after Verse 13**:

> इति श्रीशवासनम् ।
> ***iti śrīśavāsanam .***
> **"Thus concludes the glorious Śavāsana."**

**Literal Translation (Verses 11–13)**

Lying supine on the ground, lying like a corpse, [is] Śavāsana, which destroys fatigue and produces mental rest. It especially removes in an instant the vāta-knot located in the chest; one should daily practice the supreme posture named Śavāsana, which bestows ease. The body of one exhausted by the strains of difficult āsanas, having rested through Śavāsana, becomes fit for prāṇāyāma.

**Literary Translation (Verses 11–13)**

Lying flat on the ground on one's back, completely motionless like a corpse, is the posture called Śavāsana («the Corpse Pose»). It dispels all physical exhaustion and brings profound tranquility to the mind.

Clinically, it dissolves in a mere instant any spasmodic vātic knot (*vātagaṇḍa*) lodged in the chest. Therefore, the yogin should daily perform this supreme, comfort-bestowing posture.

When the physical body is exhausted and shaken by the rigors of strenuous āsanas, it finds deep renewal in Śavāsana and becomes perfectly qualified for the practice of prāṇāyāma.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 11**: In «a», neuter `śayanaṃ`; in «b», ungrammatical masculine `śayanaḥ`.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 11**: In «a», `sayānaṃ tacchavaṃ yathā` with North Indian graphic interchange of *śa* and *sa*; «b» normalizes to `śayānaṃ tu śavaṃ yathā`.
- **Footnote 4 to Verse 12**: «a» writes the compound `śavākhyāsanaṃ` without division.
- **Footnote 5–6 to Verse 13**: Witness «a» reads the nominative subject `kalevaram` with the active-middle verb `kalpate` ("the body, having rested, becomes fit for prāṇāyāma"); «b» reads the locative `kalevare` and passive `kalpyate`. Witness «a» exhibits classical syntax.

## 6. SIṂHĀSANA / YOGASIṂHĀSANA (LION POSE, VERSES 14–16)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 14)**

> गुल्फौ च वृषणस्याधः सीवन्याः पार्श्वयोः क्षिपेत् ।
> दक्षिणे सव्यगुल्फं तु दक्षगुल्फं तु सव्यके[1] ॥ १४ ॥

**IAST (Verse 14)**

> ***gulphau ca vṛṣaṇasyādhaḥ sīvanyāḥ pārśvayoḥ kṣipet*** ।
> ***dakṣiṇe savyagulphaṃ tu dakṣagulphaṃ tu savyake[1] ॥ 14 ॥***

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 14)**

- `gulphau` [gulpha-] — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two ankles";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `vṛṣaṇasya` [vṛṣaṇa-] — noun, masculine, genitive singular — "of the scrotum";
- `adhaḥ` — adverbial preposition — "under, beneath";
- `sīvanyāḥ` [sīvanī-] — noun, feminine, genitive singular — "of the perineal seam (perineum)";
- `pārśvayoḥ` [pārśva-] — noun, neuter, locative dual — "on both sides";
- `kṣipet` [kṣip] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "one should place / let him position";
- `dakṣiṇe` [dakṣiṇa-] — adjective, locative singular — "on the right side";
- `savyagulpham` [savya-gulpha-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the left ankle";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `dakṣagulpham` [dakṣa-gulpha-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the right ankle";
- `tu` — particle — "and";
- `savyake` [savyaka-] — adjective, locative singular — "on the left side".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 15)**

> हस्तौ जान्वोः समाधाय स्वाङ्गुलीश्च प्रसार्य च ।
> व्यात्ताननो नासिकाग्रं पश्येदेकाग्रमानसः[2] ॥ १५ ॥

**IAST (Verse 15)**

> ***hastau jānvoḥ samādhāya svāṅgulīś ca prasārya ca*** ।
> ***vyāttānano nāsikāgraṃ paśyed ekāgramānasaḥ[2] ॥ 15 ॥***

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 15)**

- `hastau` [hasta-] — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two hands";
- `jānvoḥ` [jānu-] — noun, neuter, locative dual — "on the knees";
- `samādhāya` [sam-ā-dhā] — absolutive — "having firmly placed";
- `svāṅgulīḥ` [sva-aṅgulī-] — noun, feminine, accusative plural — "one's own fingers"; sandhi before `ca`: *-ḥ* to *-ś-*;
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `prasārya` [pra-sṛ] — absolutive — "having spread wide";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `vyāttānanaḥ` [vyātta-ānana-] — bahuvrīhi compound, masculine, nominative singular (compound: `vyātta` ["wide open, agape"] + `ānana` ["mouth"]) — "with the mouth wide open";
- `nāsikāgram` [nāsikā-agra-] — compound noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the tip of the nose (nāsāgradṛṣṭi)";
- `paśyet` [paś / dṛś] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "let him gaze intently";

- ekāgramānasaḥ [ekāgra-mānasa-] — bahuvrīhi compound, masculine, nominative singular — "with a single-pointed mind".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 16)**

> सिंहासनं भवेदेतत् पूजितं योगिपुङ्गवैः ।
> बन्धत्रितयसन्धानं कुरुते चासनदुत्तमम्[३] ॥ १६ ॥

**IAST (Verse 16)**

> ***siṃhāsanaṃ bhavad etat pūjitaṃ yogipuṅgavaiḥ*** ।
> ***bandhatritayasandhānaṃ kurute cāsana-d-uttamam[३]*** ॥ ***16*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 16)**

- siṃhāsanam [siṃha-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Lion Pose (siṃhāsana)";
- bhavat [bhū] — archaic copula in «a» (*bhavat* = *bhavet*) — "is, becomes";
- etat — demonstrative pronoun, neuter, nominative singular — "this";
- pūjitam [pūjita-] — past passive participle, neuter, nominative singular — "honored, praised";
- yogipuṅgavaiḥ [yogi-puṅgava-] — noun, masculine, instrumental plural (compound: yogin + puṅgava ["bull / foremost among"]) — "by the foremost of yogins";
- bandhatritayasandhānam [bandha-tritaya-sandhāna-] — compound noun, neuter, accusative singular (compound: bandha ["lock"] + tritaya ["triad"] + sandhāna ["uniting, simultaneous engaging"]) — "the integration of the triad of bandhas";
- kurute [kṛ] — verb, present middle (ātmanepada), 3rd person singular — "it accomplishes, performs";
- ca — conjunction — "and";
- āsana-d-uttamam [āsana-uttama-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (with euphonic *-d-* in «a») — "the supreme among postures".

**Literal Translation (Verses 14–16)**

One should place the two ankles beneath the scrotum on both sides of the perineum: the left ankle on the right, and the right ankle on the left. Having placed the two hands on the knees and spreading one's fingers wide, with the mouth wide open, let him gaze at the tip of the nose with a one-pointed mind. This is Siṃhāsana, praised by the foremost of yogins; and this supreme posture accomplishes the integration of the triad of bandhas.

**Literary Translation (Verses 14–16)**

The yogin crosses his ankles beneath the scrotum on either side of the perineal seam, planting the left heel on the right side and the right heel on the left. Resting his palms firmly upon his knees with fingers splayed wide apart, he opens his mouth wide like a roaring lion and fixes his gaze single-pointedly upon the tip of his nose (nāsāgradṛṣṭi).

This royal posture is Siṃhāsana («the Lion Pose»), extolled by the greatest masters of yoga. This preeminent posture naturally accomplishes the simultaneous engagement of all three vital energy locks (mūla-, uḍḍīyāna-, and jālandhara-bandha).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 14**: Witness «a» preserves the balanced crossed formula dakṣagulphaṃ tu savyake ("the right ankle on the left"); «b» garbles this to tu dakṣiṇam.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 15**: In «a», the archaic epic term vyāttānano (*vyātta-ānana* — "mouth wide open"); «b» alters this to vyāptānano through phonetic corruption.
- **Footnote 3 to Verse 16**: Witness «a» has the archaic sandhi cāsanaduttamam with euphonic dental *-d-*; «b» regularizes to classical cāsanottamam.

## 7. BHADRĀSANA (BENIGN POSE, VERSE 17)

**Devanāgarī**

> गुल्फौ च वृषणस्याधः सीवन्याः पार्श्वयोः क्षिपेत् ।
> पादौ तु पाणिभ्यां धृत्वा बद्धवत् स्थापयेद् दृढम्[1] ॥
> भद्रासनं भवेदेतत् सर्वव्याधिविषापहम्[2] ॥ १७ ॥

**IAST**

> ***gulphau ca vṛṣaṇasyādhaḥ sīvanyāḥ pārśvayoḥ kṣipet*** ।
> ***pādau tu pāṇibhyāṃ dhṛtvā baddhavat sthāpayed dṛḍham[1]*** ॥
> ***bhadrāsanaṃ bhavad etat sarvavyādhiviṣāpaham[2]*** ॥ *17* ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `gulphau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two ankles";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `vṛṣaṇasya` — noun, masculine, genitive singular — "of the scrotum";
- `adhaḥ` — adverbial preposition — "beneath, under";
- `sīvanyāḥ` — noun, feminine, genitive singular — "of the perineal seam";
- `pārśvayoḥ` — noun, neuter, locative dual — "on both sides";
- `kṣipet` — verb, optative, 3rd person singular — "one should place";
- `pādau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two feet";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `pāṇibhyām` — noun, masculine, instrumental dual — "with the two hands";
- `dhṛtvā` — absolutive — "having grasped, holding";
- `baddhavat` — adverb — "as if bound, securely locked";
- `sthāpayet` — verb, causative optative, 3rd person singular — "let him keep firmly";
- `dṛḍham` — adverb — "firmly, immovably";
- `bhadrāsanam` [bhadra-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Benign Pose (bhadrāsana)";
- `bhavat` — copula in «a» (*bhavat* = *bhavet*) — "is, becomes";
- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `sarvavyādhiviṣāpaham` [sarva-vyādhi-viṣa-apaha-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "destroying all diseases and poisons".

**Literal Translation**

One should place the two ankles beneath the scrotum on both sides of the perineum; and holding the two feet with the hands, let him firmly keep [them] as if bound. This is Bhadrāsana, which destroys all diseases and poisons.

**Literary Translation**

Placing both ankles beneath the scrotum on either side of the perineal seam, the yogin clasps his joined feet firmly with both hands and holds them immovably locked. This is Bhadrāsana («the Benign Pose»); it eradicates all bodily afflictions and neutralizes toxic poisons within the system.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 17**: Witness «a» has the correct dual `pādau tu pāṇibhyāṃ`; «b» drops vowel length with corrupt `padau ca`.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 17**: Witness «a» features the compound `sarvavyādhiviṣāpaham` with Sundaradeva's signature *-apaha* suffix; «b» substitutes the synonym `sarvavyādhiviṣanāśanam`.

## 8. VĪRĀSANA (HERO POSE, VERSES 18–19)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 18)**

> एकपादं तथैकस्मिन् जानुन्यूरौ तु विन्यसेत्[3] ।
> वीरासनं भवेदेतत् सर्वकामप्रदं स्मृतम्[4] ॥ १८ ॥

**IAST (Verse 18)**

> ***ekapādaṃ tathaikasmin jānuny ūrau tu vinyaset[3]*** ।
> ***vīrāsanaṃ bhavad etat sarvakāmapradaṃ smṛtam[4]*** ॥ ***18*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 18)**

- `ekapādam` [eka-pāda-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "one foot";
- `tathā` — conjunction — "likewise, also";
- `ekasmin` [eka-] — numeral adjective, locative singular (sandhi: *tathā* + *ekasmin* = *tathaikasmin*) — "on one [thigh]";
- `jānuni` [jānu-] — noun, neuter, locative singular (sandhi: *-i* to *-y-* before vowel) — "at the knee";
- `ūrau` [ūru-] — noun, masculine, locative singular — "on the thigh";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `vinyaset` [vi-ni-as] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "one should place";
- `vīrāsanam` [vīra-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Hero Pose (vīrāsana)";
- `bhavat` — copula in «a» — "is";
- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `sarvakāmapradam` [sarva-kāma-prada-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "bestowing all desires";
- `smṛtam` [smṛta-] — past passive participle — "declared in tradition".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 19)**

> वीरासनस्थः पुरुषो धृतिमान् विजितेन्द्रियः ।
> कुर्यादभ्यासमात्मार्थं ज्ञानसम्पत्तये शुभम् ॥ १९ ॥

**IAST (Verse 19)**

> ***vīrāsanasthaḥ puruṣo dhṛtimān vijitendriyaḥ*** ।
> ***kuryād abhyāsam ātmārthaṃ jñānasaṃpattaye śubham*** ॥ ***19*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 19)**

- `vīrāsanasthaḥ` — compound adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "abiding in Vīrāsana";
- `puruṣaḥ` — noun, masculine, nominative singular — "a man, practitioner";
- `dhṛtimān` [dhṛti-mat] — adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "resolute, steadfast";
- `vijitendriyaḥ` — bahuvrīhi compound, masculine, nominative singular — "having conquered the senses";
- `kuryāt` [kṛ] — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "should perform";
- `abhyāsam` [abhyāsa-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "yogic practice";
- `ātmārtham` [ātma-artham] — adverbial compound — "for the sake of the Self (Ātman)";
- `jñānasaṃpattaye` [jñāna-saṃpatti-] — noun, feminine, dative of purpose — "for the attainment of knowledge";
- `śubham` [śubha-] — adjective, masculine, accusative singular (agreeing with *abhyāsam*) — "auspicious, pure".

**Literal Translation (Verses 18–19)**

One foot likewise let him place on one thigh near the knee; this is Vīrāsana, declared as bestowing all desires. A man seated in Vīrāsana, steadfast and having conquered his senses, should perform auspicious practice for the sake of the Self and for the attainment of knowledge.

**Literary Translation (Verses 18–19)**

Placing one foot upon the opposite thigh near the knee, the practitioner adopts Vīrāsana («the Hero Pose»), celebrated in sacred tradition as granting the fulfillment of all aspirations.

Established in the Hero Pose, resolute and with senses thoroughly subdued, the yogin must pursue his auspicious practice for the realization of the supreme Self (Ātman) and the attainment of liberating spiritual wisdom.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 3 to Verse 18**: Witness «a» has `ekasmin`; «b» adds emphatic `hy ekasmin`.
- **Footnote 4 to Verse 18**: Witness «b» regularizes `bhaved etat` for «a»'s `bhavad etat`.

## 9. KŪRMĀSANA (TORTOISE POSE, VERSE 20)

**Devanāgarī**

> गुदमवष्टभ्य गुल्फाभ्यां व्युत्क्रमेण समाहितः[1] ।
> कूर्मासनं भवेदेतत् सर्ववातरुगापहम्[2] ॥ २० ॥

**IAST**

> ***gudam avaṣṭabhya gulphābhyāṃ vyutkrameṇa samāhitaḥ[1]*** ।
> ***kūrmāsanaṃ bhavad etat sarvavātarugāpaham[2]*** ॥ ***20*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `gudam` [guda-] — noun, masculine/neuter, accusative singular — "the anus / anal sphincter";
- `avaṣṭabhya` — absolutive — "having pressed firmly against";
- `gulphābhyām` — noun, masculine, instrumental dual — "with the two ankles/heels";
- `vyutkrameṇa` [vyutkrama-] — noun, masculine, instrumental of manner — "in crossed/reverse order";
- `samāhitaḥ` — past passive participle, masculine, nominative singular — "collected, meditative";
- `kūrmāsanam` [kūrma-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Tortoise Pose (kūrmāsana)";
- `bhavat` — copula in «a» — "is";
- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `sarvavātarugāpaham` [sarva-vāta-ruj-apaha-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular (compound: `sarva` ["all"] + `vāta` ["wind humor"] + `ruj` ["diseases"] + `apaha` ["destroying"]) — "curing all 80 disorders of the vāta humor".

**Literal Translation**

Having pressed the anus with the two ankles in crossed order, the concentrated [yogin executes this]: this is Kūrmāsana, which destroys all vāta diseases.

**Literary Translation**

With focused concentration, the yogin crosses his ankles and firmly presses both heels against the perineum and anus. This posture is Kūrmāsana («the Tortoise Pose»); it comprehensively cures all eighty varieties of pathological vāta disorders.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 20**: In «a», instrumental of manner `vyutkrameṇa` ("in crossed order"); «b» reads ablative with particle `vyutkramāt tu`.
- **Medical Significance**: The term `sarvavātarugāpaham` refers directly to the eighty classical Āyurvedic neurological and musculoskeletal disorders of vāta (*vātaja nānātmaja vyādhi*). Compressing the anal region stimulates *apāna-vāyu*, balancing downward visceral pressure.

## 10. PRASĀRITĀSANA (EXTENDED POSE, VERSE 21)

**Devanāgarī**

> प्रसार्य पादौ भूमौ तु कराभ्यां धारयेत् पदम्[1] ।
> प्रसारितासनं प्रोक्तं राजयोगप्रसाधकम्[2] ॥ २१ ॥

**IAST**

> ***prasārya pādau bhūmau tu karābhyāṃ dhārayet padam[1]*** ।
> ***prasāritāsanaṃ proktaṃ rājayogaprasādhakam[2]*** ॥ ***21*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis**

- `prasārya` — absolutive — "having extended, spreading out";
- `pādau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two legs / feet";
- `bhūmau` — noun, feminine, locative singular — "on the ground";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `karābhyām` — noun, masculine, instrumental dual — "with the two hands";
- `dhārayet` — verb, causative optative, 3rd person singular — "one should hold";
- `padam` — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the feet / foot position";
- `prasāritāsanam` [prasārita-āsana-] — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Extended Pose (prasāritāsana)";
- `proktam` — past passive participle — "is proclaimed";
- `rājayogaprasādhakam` [rājayoga-prasādhaka-] — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "accomplishing success in Rāja Yoga".

**Literal Translation**

Having extended the two legs on the ground, let him hold the feet with the two hands; [this] is declared Prasāritāsana, which accomplishes Rāja Yoga.

**Literary Translation**

Extending both legs straight out upon the ground, the yogin grasps his feet firmly with both hands. This posture is proclaimed as Prasāritāsana («the Extended Pose»); it establishes an unwavering physical foundation that brings about mastery in Rāja Yoga.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 21**: In «a», the accurate dual `pādau`; «b» corrupts this to singular `pādaṃ`.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 21**: In «a», `proktaṃ` ("proclaimed"); «b» substitutes `jñeyam` ("should be known").

## 11. PADMĀSANA / AMBURUHĀSANA (LOTUS POSE, VERSES 22–28)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 22)**

> उत्तानौ चरणौ कृत्वा ऊरुसंस्थौ प्रयत्नतः[1] ।
> ऊर्वोर्मध्ये तथोत्थानौ हस्तौ कृत्वा ततो दृशम्[2] ॥ २२ ॥

**IAST (Verse 22)**

> ***uttānau caraṇau kṛtvā ūrusamsthau prayatnataḥ[1]*** ।
> ***ūrvor madhye tathotthānau hastau kṛtvā tato dṛśam[2]*** ॥ ***22*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 22)**

- `uttānau` — adjective, masculine, accusative dual — "turned soles upward";
- `caraṇau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two feet";
- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having placed, having made";
- `ūrusamsthau` — compound adjective, masculine, accusative dual — "resting upon the opposite thighs";

- `prayatnataḥ` — adverb — "with diligence and careful effort";
- `ūrvoḥ` — noun, masculine, genitive dual — "of the thighs";
- `madhye` — locative singular — "in the middle, between";
- `tathā` — conjunction — "likewise";
- `utthānau` — adjective, masculine, accusative dual (in «a»; «b» reads *uttānau*) — "with palms turned upwards";
- `hastau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two hands";
- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having positioned";
- `tatas` — adverb — "then";
- `dṛśam` — noun, feminine, accusative singular — "the gaze, sight".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 23)**

> नासाग्रे विन्यसेद् राजदन्त मूले तु जिह्वया[3] ।
> उत्तम्भ्य चिबुकं वक्षस्युत्थाप्य पवनं शनैः[4] ॥ २३ ॥

**IAST (Verse 23)**

> ***nāsāgre vinyased rāja-danta-mūle tu jihvayā[3]*** ।
> ***uttambhya cibukaṃ vakṣasy utthāpya pavanaṃ śanaiḥ[4]*** ॥ ***23*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 23)**

- `nāsāgre` — locative singular — "on the tip of the nose (nāsāgradṛṣṭi)";
- `vinyaset` — verb, optative active, 3rd person singular — "one should fix";
- `rāja-danta-mūle` — locative singular (compound: `rājadanta` ["front upper incisors"] + `mūla` ["root"]) — "at the roots of the front teeth (nabhomudrā)";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `jihvayā` — noun, feminine, instrumental singular — "with the tongue";
- `uttambhya` — absolutive — "having pressed firmly against";
- `cibukam` — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the chin";
- `vakṣasi` — noun, neuter, locative singular — "against the chest (jālandharabandha)";
- `utthāpya` — absolutive (causative) — "drawing upward";
- `pavanam` — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the vital breath / apāna breath";
- `śanaiḥ` — adverb — "slowly, gradually".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 24)**

> पद्मासनं भवेदेतत् सर्वव्याधिविनाशनम्[1] ।
> दुर्लभं येन केनापि धीमता लभ्यते भुवि ॥ २४ ॥

**IAST (Verse 24)**

> ***padmāsanaṃ bhavad etat sarvavyādhivināśanam[1]*** ।
> ***durlabhaṃ yena kenāpi dhīmatā labhyate bhuvi*** ॥ ***24*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 24)**

- `padmāsanam` — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Lotus Pose (padmāsana)";
- `bhavat` — copula in «a» — "is";
- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `sarvavyādhivināśanam` — compound adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "destroying all diseases";
- `durlabham` — adjective, neuter, nominative singular — "difficult to attain, rare";
- `yena kenāpi` — instrumental phrase — "by any ordinary person [unattainable]";

- `dhīmatā` — adjective functioning as noun, masculine, instrumental singular — "by the wise [yogin]";
- `labhyate` — verb, present passive, 3rd person singular — "is attained, is mastered";
- `bhuvi` — noun, feminine, locative singular — "on earth / in this world".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 25)**

> कृत्वा संपुटितौ करौ अथ तले वामोरुसंस्थं परं
> दक्षोरौ तु विनास्य तस्योपरि विन्यसेदितरकं पादं ततो योजयेत् ।
> नासाग्रे विनिवेशयेदथ दृशं जिह्वाग्रसंस्थोपरि
> दन्तानां च तले निधाय चिबुकं वक्षःस्थले दापयेत्[२] ॥ २५ ॥

**IAST (Verse 25)**

> ***kṛtvā saṃpuṭitau karāv atha tale vāmoru-saṃsthaṃ paraṃ***
> ***dakṣorau tu vināsya tasyopari vinyased itarakaṃ pādaṃ tato yojayet*** ।
> ***nāsāgre viniveśayed atha dṛśaṃ jihvāgra-saṃsthopari***
> ***dantānāṃ ca tale nidhāya cibukaṃ vakṣaḥsthale dāpayet[२]*** ॥ ***25*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 25)**

- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having made";
- `saṃpuṭitau` — adjective, masculine, accusative dual — "cupped together / folded in a bowl-like clasp";
- `karau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "the two hands";
- `atha` — particle — "then";
- `tale` — locative singular — "in the lap / below";
- `vāmoru-saṃstham` — compound adjective, accusative singular — "resting upon the left thigh";
- `param` — adjective — "one [foot]";
- `dakṣorau` — locative singular — "upon the right thigh";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `vināsya` — absolutive — "having placed";
- `tasya` — genitive singular — "of that [thigh]";
- `upari` — postposition — "upon, on top of";
- `vinyaset` — verb, optative — "one should place";
- `itarakam` — adjective, accusative singular — "the other";
- `pādam` — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "foot";
- `tatas` — adverb — "then";
- `yojayet` — verb, optative causative — "let him harmonize / engage";
- `nāsāgre` — locative singular — "on the tip of the nose";
- `viniveśayet` — verb, optative causative — "let him firmly fix";
- `dṛśam` — noun, feminine, accusative singular — "the gaze";
- `jihvāgra-saṃsthopari` — adverbial compound — "the tip of the tongue placed upwards";
- `dantānām` — genitive plural — "of the teeth";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `tale` — locative singular — "at the roots / gums";
- `nidhāya` — absolutive — "having placed";
- `cibukam` — accusative singular — "the chin";
- `vakṣaḥsthale` — locative singular — "against the chest";
- `dāpayet` — verb, optative causative — "let him press firmly".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 26)**

> इदं पद्मासनं प्रोक्तं सर्वव्याधिविनाशनम् ।
> दुरासदं हि सर्वेषां क्षितौ धीमद्भिराप्यते ॥ २६ ॥

**IAST (Verse 26)**

> ***idaṃ padmāsanaṃ proktaṃ sarvavyādhivināśanam*** ।
> ***durāsadaṃ hi sarveṣāṃ kṣitau dhīmadbhir āpyate*** ॥ ***26*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 26)**

- `idam` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `padmāsanam` — nominative singular — "Lotus Pose (padmāsana)";
- `proktam` — past passive participle — "proclaimed";
- `sarvavyādhivināśanam` — compound adjective — "destroying all diseases";
- `durāsadam` — adjective — "unapproachable, exceedingly difficult to master";
- `hi` — particle — "indeed";
- `sarveṣām` — genitive plural — "for all [ordinary mortals]";
- `kṣitau` — locative singular — "on earth";
- `dhīmadbhiḥ` — instrumental plural of agent — "by the wise";
- `āpyate` — verb, present passive — "is attained".

**Colophon after Verse 26**:

> इति श्रीपद्मासनम् ।
> ***iti śrīpadmāsanam .***
> **"Thus concludes the glorious Padmāsana."**

**Devanāgarī (Verse 27: Internal Meditation Instructions)**

> कृत्वा पद्मासनं सम्यक् संपुटौ च करावुभौ[1] ।
> चिबुकं वक्षसि न्यस्य ध्यायेच्च तन्मना हरिम्[2] ॥ २७ ॥

**IAST (Verse 27)**

> ***kṛtvā padmāsanaṃ samyak saṃpuṭau ca karāv ubhau[1]*** ।
> ***cibukaṃ vakṣasi nyasya dhyāyec ca tanmanā harim[2]*** ॥ ***27*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 27)**

- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having adopted";
- `padmāsanam` — accusative singular — "Padmāsana";
- `samyak` — adverb — "properly, flawlessly";
- `saṃpuṭau` — accusative dual — "cupped together";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `karau` — accusative dual — "the two hands";
- `ubhau` — numeral dual — "both";
- `cibukam` — accusative singular — "the chin";
- `vakṣasi` — locative singular — "against the chest";
- `nyasya` — absolutive — "having pressed";
- `dhyāyet` — verb, optative active — "let him meditate";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `tanmanāḥ` [tad-manas] — bahuvrīhi adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "with his mind fixed entirely upon Him";

- `harim` [hari-] — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "Lord Hari (Viṣṇu / the Supreme Lord)".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 28: Balancing Prāṇa and Apāna)**

> वारं वारमपानं तूर्ध्वमुत्थापयेच्छनैः[3] ।
> प्राणं च क्षिपेन्नीचं प्राणापानौ समौ चरेत्[4] ॥ २८ ॥

**IAST (Verse 28)**

> ***vāraṃ vāram apānaṃ tūrdhvam utthāpayec chanaiḥ[3]*** ।
> ***prāṇaṃ ca kṣipen nīcaṃ prāṇāpānau samau caret[4]*** ॥ ***28*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 28)**

- `vāram vāram` — adverbial repetition — "again and again, repeatedly";
- `apānam` — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the downward breath apāna (apāna-vāyu)";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `ūrdhvam` — directional adverb — "upward [into the suṣumnā]";
- `utthāpayet` — verb, optative causative — "one should draw upward";
- `śanaiḥ` — adverb — "slowly, gently";
- `prāṇam` — noun, masculine, accusative singular — "the vital breath prāṇa (prāṇa-vāyu)";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `kṣipet` — verb, optative active — "one should direct downward";
- `nīcam` — directional adverb — "downward";
- `prāṇāpānau` — noun, masculine, accusative dual — "prāṇa and apāna";
- `samau` — adjective, accusative dual — "equal, balanced";
- `caret` — verb, optative active — "one should make / maintain".

**Literal Translation (Verses 22–28)**

Having placed the two feet turned upwards upon the thighs with effort, having placed the two hands between the thighs turned upwards, then the gaze let him fix on the tip of the nose, with the tongue at the root of the upper incisors, pressing the chin against the chest, drawing the breath slowly upward. This is Padmāsana, destroying all diseases. Difficult to attain by any ordinary person, it is mastered on earth by the wise. Having properly performed Padmāsana and cupping both hands together, pressing the chin against the chest, let him meditate on Lord Hari, his mind absorbed in Him. Again and again let him slowly draw apāna upward, and direct prāṇa downward, making prāṇa and apāna balanced.

**Literary Translation (Verses 22–28)**

Placing the feet upon the opposite thighs with soles turned upwards, the yogin cups his hands in his lap, fixes his gaze upon the tip of the nose (nāsāgradṛṣṭi), curls the tip of the tongue against the palate behind the front teeth (nabhomudrā), and firmly locks the chin against the jugular notch of the chest (jālandharabandha).

This is Padmāsana («the Lotus Pose»), the sovereign destroyer of all physical ailments. Almost unachievable for the common run of mankind, it is mastered in this world only by the truly wise.

Properly seated in Padmāsana with hands cupped together, chin pressed to the chest, the practitioner withdraws his mind from external objects and meditates single-mindedly upon the Supreme Lord Hari. Again and again, he gently draws the descending apāna breath upward (mūlabandha) while directing the ascending prāṇa downward, equalizing them in the navel fire and forcing the vital energy into the central channel (*suṣumnā*).

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 22**: In «a», `prayatnataḥ` ("with diligent effort"); «b» reads `samāhitaḥ` ("concentrated").
- **Footnote 4 to Verse 23**: In «a», `utthāpya pavanam` ("drawing the breath upward"); «b» has `ucchārya` ("uttering"). Reading «a» represents the core Haṭha yogic term for apāna reversal (*apānothāpana*).

- **Footnotes to Verses 27–28**: Witness «a» reads `tanmanā harim` ("mind absorbed in Hari"); «b» offers the impersonal `tanmayam`. In Verse 28, witness «a» correctly preserves `samau caret` ("make equal").

## 12. BADDHAPADMĀSANA (BOUND LOTUS POSE, VERSES 29–32)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 29)**

> पद्मासनं समाधाय विन्यसेद् वामपाणिना[1] ।
> दक्षिणाङ्गुष्ठयुग्मं तु पृष्ठदेशात् समाहितः[2] ॥ २९ ॥

**IAST (Verse 29)**

> ***padmāsanaṃ samādhāya vinyased vāmapāṇinā[1]*** ।
> ***dakṣiṇāṅguṣṭha-yugmaṃ tu pṛṣṭhadeśāt samāhitaḥ[2]*** ॥ ***29*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 29)**

- `padmāsanam` — accusative singular — "Lotus Pose";
- `samādhāya` — absolutive — "having established firmly";
- `vinyaset` — verb, optative active — "one should grasp";
- `vāmapāṇinā` — instrumental singular — "with the left hand";
- `dakṣiṇāṅguṣṭha-yugmam` — compound noun, accusative singular — "the right big toe";
- `tu` — particle — "indeed";
- `pṛṣṭhadeśāt` — ablative of direction — "from behind the back";
- `samāhitaḥ` — nominative singular — "the concentrated yogin".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 30)**

> वामेन च तथा पृष्ठाद् गृहीत्वाङ्गुष्ठमितरम् ।
> बद्धपद्मासनं ज्ञेयं वातकफज्वरापहम् ॥ ३० ॥

**IAST (Verse 30)**

> ***vāmena ca tathā pṛṣṭhād gṛhītvāṅguṣṭham itaram*** ।
> ***baddhapadmāsanaṃ jñeyaṃ vātakaphajvarāpaham*** ॥ ***30*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 30)**

- `vāmena` — instrumental singular — "[with the other, right hand / or left]";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `tathā` — adverb — "likewise";
- `pṛṣṭhāt` — ablative — "from behind the back";
- `gṛhītvā` — absolutive — "having grasped";
- `aṅguṣṭham` — accusative singular — "the big toe";
- `itaram` — adjective, accusative singular — "the other";
- `baddhapadmāsanam` — compound noun, nominative singular — "Bound Lotus Pose (baddhapadmāsana)";
- `jñeyam` — gerundive — "should be known";
- `vātakaphajvarāpaham` — compound adjective — "curing fevers caused by vāta and kapha".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 31: Citation from the Yogacandrikā)**

> पृष्ठात् कराभ्यां संगृह्य पादाङ्गुष्ठौ निबध्नीयात्[1] ।
> बद्धपद्मासनं ह्येतद् विषदोषहरास्पदम्[2] ॥ ३१ ॥

**IAST (Verse 31)**

> ***pṛṣṭhāt karābhyāṃ saṅgṛhya pādāṅguṣṭhau nibadhnīyāt[1]*** ।
> ***baddhapadmāsanaṃ hy etad viṣadoṣaharāspadam[2]*** ॥ ***31*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 31)**

- `pṛṣṭhāt` — ablative — "from behind the back";
- `karābhyām` — instrumental dual — "with both hands";
- `saṅgṛhya` — absolutive — "having firmly taken hold of";
- `pādāṅguṣṭhau` — accusative dual — "the two big toes";
- `nibadhnīyāt` [ni-bandh] — verb, optative active 9th class, 3rd person singular — "one should bind / securely lock";
- `baddhapadmāsanam` — nominative singular — "Bound Lotus Pose";
- `hi` — particle — "indeed";
- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `viṣadoṣaharāspadam` — compound noun/adjective — "the seat/fountainhead of the destruction of poisons and doṣas".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 32)**

> नानारोगहरं पुंसां योगिनां च सुखावहम् ।
> इति योगचन्द्रिकोक्तं बद्धपद्मासनम् ॥ ३२ ॥

**IAST (Verse 32)**

> ***nānā-roga-haraṃ puṃsāṃ yogināṃ ca sukhāvaham*** ।
> ***iti yogacandrikoktaṃ baddhapadmāsanam*** ॥ ***32*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 32)**

- `nānā-roga-haram` — compound adjective — "destroying manifold diseases";
- `puṃsām` — genitive plural — "of human beings";
- `yoginām` — genitive plural — "for yogins";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `sukhāvaham` — compound adjective — "bringing ease and bliss";
- `iti` — quotation marker — "thus";
- `yogacandrikoktam` — compound participle — "stated in the *Yogacandrikā*";
- `baddhapadmāsanam` — nominative singular — "Bound Lotus Pose".

**Literal Translation (Verses 29–32)**

Having established Padmāsana, with the left hand let the concentrated yogin grasp the right big toe from behind the back. And likewise from behind the back with the [other] hand having grasped the other big toe, this should be known as Baddhapadmāsana, which cures fevers of vāta and kapha. Having grasped the two big toes from behind with both hands, let him bind them. This Baddhapadmāsana is indeed the seat of the destruction of poisons and doṣas, destroying manifold diseases of men and bringing bliss to yogins. Thus is Baddhapadmāsana stated in the *Yogacandrikā*.

**Literary Translation (Verses 29–32)**

Assuming the Lotus Pose, the focused yogin reaches around his back with his left hand to grasp the big toe of the right foot, and reaches behind with his right hand to grasp the toe of the left foot. This locked posture is known as Baddhapadmāsana («the Bound Lotus»); clinically, it dispels stubborn mixed fevers caused by aggravated vāta and kapha.

As affirmed in the authoritative *Yogacandrikā*: «Reaching behind the back with both arms, the practitioner tightly binds the toes of both feet. Verily, this Bound Lotus is an unfailing fountainhead for eradicating internal toxins and humors; it purges the manifold maladies of mortals and confers serene bliss upon the yogins».

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 29**: In «a», `vāmapāṇinā` ("with the left hand"); in «b», `dakṣapāṇinā` ("with the right hand"). Both manuscripts capture mirror executions of the arm lock behind the back.
- **Footnote 1 to Verse 31**: In «a», the precise 9th-class optative verb `nibadhnīyāt` ("let him bind"); «b» dilutes this with the generic participle `samāhitaḥ`.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 31**: In «a», the evocative `viṣadoṣaharāspadam` ("abode of the destruction of toxins and doṣas"); «b» substitutes the cliché `viṣadoṣaharaṃ smṛtam`.

## 13. SIDDHĀSANA / YONYĀSANA (ACCOMPLISHED POSE, VERSES 33–40)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 33)**

> योनिसथानकमङ्घ्रिमूलघटितं कृत्वा दृढं विन्यसेत्[3]
> पादेऽन्यं चरकं तथोरुमध्ये[1] न्यस्यैव संस्थापयेत् ।
> दृष्टिं भ्रूयुगलस्य मध्यगतये कृत्वा स्थिरं धीरधीः[2]
> सिद्धासनमेतदाहुरनघम्[3] उन्मीलितं योगिभिः ॥ ३३ ॥

**IAST (Verse 33)**

> ***yoni-sthānakam aṅghri-mūla-ghaṭitaṃ kṛtvā dṛḍhaṃ vinyaset[3]***
> ***pāde 'nyaṃ carakaṃ tathoru-madhye[1] nyasyaiva saṃsthāpayet*** ।
> ***dṛṣṭiṃ bhrūyugalasya madhyagataye kṛtvā sthiraṃ dhīra-dhīḥ[2]***
> ***siddhāsanam etad āhur anagham[3] unmīlitaṃ yogibhiḥ*** ॥ ***33*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 33)**

- `yoni-sthānakam` — compound noun, neuter, accusative singular — "the perineal region (yoni-sthāna)";
- `aṅghri-mūla-ghaṭitam` — compound adjective, accusative singular — "pressed against the base of the foot (heel)";
- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having placed";
- `dṛḍham` — adverb — "firmly, solidly";
- `vinyaset` — verb, optative active — "one should position";
- `pāde` — locative singular — "upon the foot / above the foot";
- `anyam` — accusative singular — "the other [foot]";
- `carakam` — accusative singular in «a» (scribal slip for *caraṇam*) — "foot";
- `tathā` — conjunction — "likewise";
- `ūru-madhye` — locative singular — "between the thighs / above the pubis";
- `nyasya` — absolutive — "having placed";
- `eva` — emphatic particle — "indeed";
- `saṃsthāpayet` — verb, causative optative — "let him firmly establish";
- `dṛṣṭim` — accusative singular — "the gaze (dṛṣṭi)";
- `bhrūyugalasya` — genitive singular — "of the pair of eyebrows";
- `madhyagataye` — dative/locative compound in «a» — "to rest in the center between the eyebrows (śāmbhavīmudrā)";
- `sthiram` — adverb — "steadily, motionlessly";
- `dhīra-dhīḥ` — bahuvrīhi adjective, masculine, nominative singular — "the yogin of resolute intellect";
- `siddhāsanam` — noun, neuter, accusative singular — "Accomplished Pose (siddhāsana)";

- etat — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- āhuḥ — verb, perfect active 3rd person plural — "they declare";
- anagham — adjective, neuter, accusative singular — "faultless, pristine";
- unmīlitam — past passive participle — "revealed, disclosed";
- yogibhiḥ — instrumental plural of agent — "by the yogins".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 34: Technique of Yonyāsana)**

> योनिसथानं समालम्ब्य वामपाष्ण्र्या प्रयत्नतः ।
> दक्षिणां पार्ष्णिमप्येवं मेढ्रस्योपरि विन्यसेत् ॥ ३४ ॥

**IAST (Verse 34)**

> ***yonisthānaṃ samālambhya vāmapārṣṇyā prayatnataḥ*** ।
> ***dakṣiṇāṃ pārṣṇim apy evaṃ meḍhrasyopari vinyaset*** ॥ ***34*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 34)**

- yonisthānam — accusative singular — "the perineum";
- samālambhya — absolutive — "firmly pressing against";
- vāmapārṣṇyā — instrumental singular feminine — "with the left heel";
- prayatnataḥ — adverb — "with diligence";
- dakṣiṇām — accusative singular feminine — "the right";
- pārṣṇim — accusative singular feminine — "heel";
- api — particle — "also";
- evam — adverb — "in this manner";
- meḍhrasya — genitive singular — "of the male organ (penis / pubic bone)";
- upari — postposition — "above, over";
- vinyaset — optative — "one should place".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 35)**

> चिबुकं वक्षसि न्यस्य सुस्थिरो विजितेन्द्रियः ।
> जलन्धरबन्धं कृत्वा नासाग्रे विन्यसेद् दृशम् ॥ ३५ ॥

**IAST (Verse 35)**

> ***cibukaṃ vakṣasi nyasya susthiro vijitendriyaḥ*** ।
> ***jalandharabandhaṃ kṛtvā nāsāgre vinyased dṛśam*** ॥ ***35*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 35)**

- cibukam — accusative singular — "the chin";
- vakṣasi — locative singular — "against the chest";
- nyasya — absolutive — "having pressed";
- susthiraḥ — adjective, nominative singular — "perfectly motionless";
- vijitendriyaḥ — bahuvrīhi, nominative singular — "having conquered the senses";
- jalandharabandham — accusative singular — "the chin lock (jālandharabandha)";
- kṛtvā — absolutive — "having executed";
- nāsāgre — locative singular — "on the tip of the nose";
- vinyaset — optative — "let him fix";
- dṛśam — accusative singular — "the gaze".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 36: Exaltation of Yonyāsana)**

> एतद् योन्यासनं प्रोक्तं सिद्धासनमिति स्मृतम् ।
> योन्यासनेन संसिद्धः किं न सिध्यति भूतले ॥ ३६ ॥

**IAST (Verse 36)**

> ***etad yonyāsanaṃ proktaṃ siddhāsanam iti smṛtam*** ।
> ***yonyāsanena saṃsiddhaḥ kiṃ na sidhyati bhūtale*** ॥ ***36*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 36)**

- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `yonyāsanam` — nominative singular — "Yonyāsana (Perineal Pose)";
- `proktam` — past participle — "proclaimed";
- `siddhāsanam` — nominative singular — "Siddhāsana (Accomplished Pose)";
- `iti` — quotation particle — "thus";
- `smṛtam` — past participle — "remembered in tradition";
- `yonyāsanena` — instrumental singular — "by means of Yonyāsana";
- `saṃsiddhaḥ` — past participle as noun — "one who has perfected it";
- `kim` — interrogative pronoun — "what?";
- `na` — negative particle — "not";
- `sidhyati` — verb, present active 4th class — "is accomplished, succeeds";
- `bhūtale` — locative singular — "on the surface of the earth".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 37)**

> ब्रह्मचारी मिताहारी त्यागी योगपरायणः ।
> अब्दादूर्ध्वं भवेत् सिद्धो नात्र कार्या विचारणा ॥ ३७ ॥

**IAST (Verse 37)**

> ***brahmacārī mitāhārī tyāgī yogaparāyaṇaḥ*** ।
> ***abdād ūrdhvaṃ bhavet siddho nātra kāryā vicāraṇā*** ॥ ***37*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 37)**

- `brahmacārī` — adjective, nominative singular — "practicing celibacy / conservation of vital energy";
- `mitāhārī` — adjective, nominative singular — "eating moderately";
- `tyāgī` — adjective, nominative singular — "renouncing worldly attachments";
- `yogaparāyaṇaḥ` — bahuvrīhi, nominative singular — "wholly devoted to yoga";
- `abdāt` — ablative of time — "after a year";
- `ūrdhvam` — adverb — "beyond, after the passage of";
- `bhavet` — optative — "he becomes";
- `siddhaḥ` — noun/adjective — "an accomplished master (siddha)";
- `na` — negative — "no";
- `atra` — adverb — "here, in this matter";
- `kāryā` — gerundive feminine — "should be entertained";
- `vicāraṇā` — noun, feminine, nominative singular — "doubt, hesitation".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 38: The Medical Analogy of Diet)**

> यथा पथ्याशिनः साध्यं चिकित्सा न विरुध्यते ।
> तथा मिताशिनो योगः सिध्यत्येव न संशयः ॥ ३८ ॥

**IAST (Verse 38)**

> ***yathā pathyāśinaḥ sādhyaṃ cikitsā na virudhyate*** ।
> ***tathā mitāśino yogaḥ sidhyaty eva na saṃśayaḥ*** ॥ ***38*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 38)**

- `yathā` — comparative conjunction — "just as";
- `pathyāśinaḥ` — genitive singular — "of one who adheres to a prescribed therapeutic diet (*pathya*)";
- `sādhyam` — gerundive as noun — "the curable outcome / therapeutic success";
- `cikitsā` — noun, feminine, nominative singular — "medical treatment, therapeutics";
- `na` — negative — "not";
- `virudhyate` — passive verb — "is obstructed, fails";
- `tathā` — correlative adverb — "so likewise";
- `mitāśinaḥ` — genitive singular — "of one who eats moderately";
- `yogaḥ` — noun, nominative singular — "yoga";
- `sidhyati` — verb, present active — "attains fruition, succeeds";
- `eva` — emphatic particle — "verily, surely";
- `na` — negative — "no";
- `saṃśayaḥ` — noun, nominative singular — "doubt".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 39)**

> किं शीर्षासनजालेन योन्यासनपरायणः ।
> प्राणस्य संयमं कृत्वा मुच्यते सर्वपातकैः ॥ ३९ ॥

**IAST (Verse 39)**

> ***kiṃ śīrṣāsanajālena yonyāsana-parāyaṇaḥ*** ।
> ***prāṇasya saṃyamaṃ kṛtvā mucyate sarvapātakaiḥ*** ॥ ***39*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 39)**

- `kim` — rhetorical interrogative — "what need is there? what use?";
- `śīrṣāsanajālena` — instrumental singular (compound: `śīrṣāsana` ["Headstand"] + `jāla` ["web, multiplicity"]) — "with the multiplicity of headstands (śīrṣāsanas)?";
- `yonyāsana-parāyaṇaḥ` — nominative singular — "one devoted to Yonyāsana";
- `prāṇasya` — genitive singular — "of the vital breath";
- `saṃyamam` — accusative singular — "control, mastery";
- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having achieved";
- `mucyate` — verb, present passive 4th class — "is liberated";
- `sarvapātakaiḥ` — instrumental/ablative plural — "from all sins, impurities, and karmic taints".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 40: The Sovereignty of Siddhāsana)**

> आसनेष्वेव सर्वेषु सिद्धासनमुदाहृतम् ।
> यथा न वारिषु गङ्गा तथा चासनमुत्तमम् ॥ ४० ॥

**IAST (Verse 40)**

> ***āsaneṣv eva sarveṣu siddhāsanam udāhṛtam*** ।
> ***yathā na vāriṣu gaṅgā tathā cāsanam uttamam*** ॥ ***40*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 40)**

- `āsaneṣu` — locative plural — "among postures";
- `eva` — emphatic particle — "indeed";

- `sarveṣu` — locative plural — "all";
- `siddhāsanam` — nominative singular — "Siddhāsana";
- `udāhṛtam` — past passive participle — "is declared [supreme]";
- `yathā` — comparative — "just as";
- `na` — negative particle in superlative comparison — "truly [none equals]";
- `vāriṣu` — locative plural — "among all waters/rivers";
- `gaṅgā` — nominative singular — "the holy river Gaṅgā";
- `tathā` — correlative — "so likewise";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `āsanam` — nominative singular — "posture";
- `uttamam` — superlative adjective — "the supreme, peerless".

**Literal Translation (Verses 33–40)**

Having placed the perineal region firmly against the base of the foot (heel), placing the other foot likewise above between the thighs, fixing the gaze steadily in the center between the eyebrows, the resolute yogin [performs this]: this faultless posture, revealed by yogins, they declare to be Siddhāsana. Having firmly pressed the perineum with the left heel, let him place the right heel likewise above the male organ. Pressing the chin to the chest, perfectly motionless, with senses conquered, having performed jālandharabandha, let him fix the gaze on the tip of the nose. This is declared Yonyāsana, remembered as Siddhāsana. For one perfected through Yonyāsana, what on earth is not accomplished? Celibate, moderate in diet, renouncing, devoted to yoga, after a year he becomes a siddha; no doubt should be entertained here. Just as for one eating a wholesome diet medical treatment does not fail, so for one who eats moderately yoga certainly succeeds, no doubt. What is the use of a multiplicity of headstands? Devoted to Yonyāsana, having controlled the prāṇa, one is freed from all sins. Among all postures indeed Siddhāsana is proclaimed: just as none equals Gaṅgā among waters, so this posture is supreme.

**Literary Translation (Verses 33–40)**

Firmly lodging the heel of one foot against the perineal center (*yonisthāna*), the practitioner rests the other foot directly above the pubic bone. Fixing his unwavering gaze upon the space between the eyebrows (*śāmbhavīmudrā*), the steadfast yogin rests in contemplative stillness. The ancient masters declare this pristine, sacred posture to be Siddhāsana («the Accomplished Pose»).

The same discipline is known as Yonyāsana: pressing the left heel forcefully against the perineum and resting the right heel above the generative organ, the yogin locks his chin to his chest in jālandharabandha and centers his unblinking gaze upon the tip of the nose.

What achievement in the three worlds remains beyond the reach of one who has mastered Yonyāsana? Maintaining conservation of vital energy, practicing moderate diet, free from worldly entanglement, and whole-heartedly dedicated to yoga, he becomes an accomplished siddha in the span of just one year — on this point let there be no doubt!

Just as clinical medical treatment never fails in a patient who strictly adheres to the physician's prescribed diet, even so the science of yoga invariably attains fruition in one who observes moderate eating.

Why should the yogin exhaust himself with a dizzying maze of inverted headstands (*śīrṣāsana*)? Devoted entirely to Yonyāsana and mastering the vital breath, he is instantly purified of all sins and karmic afflictions.

Among all the postures taught in yoga, Siddhāsana reigns sovereign: just as no river on earth equals the sacred Gaṅgā, so no āsana in existence surpasses Siddhāsana.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 3 to Verse 33**: In «a», neuter `yonisthānakaṃ aṅghrimūlaghaṭitaṃ`; in «b», masculine `°ghaṭitaḥ`.
- **Footnote 1 to Verse 33**: In «a», `carakaṃ tathoru-madhye`; «b» regularizes to `caraṇaṃ talena`.

- **Footnote 2 to Verse 33**: In «a», `madhyagataye`; «b» reads accusative `madhyavartinam` agreeing with *dṛṣṭim*.
- **Footnote 3 to Verse 33**: In «a», `anagham` ("faultless"); in «b», `amalam` ("spotless").

## 14. PAŚCIMATĀNĀSANA (POSTERIOR STRETCH POSE, VERSES 41–43)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 41)**

> प्रसार्य पादौ भुवि दण्डरूपौ दोर्भ्यां पदाग्रद्वितयं गृहीत्वा ।
> जानूपरि न्यस्तशिराः समानो वर्तेत यस्यां रविकोटितेजः[1] ॥ ४१ ॥

**IAST (Verse 41)**

> ***prasārya pādau bhuvi daṇḍarūpau dorbhyāṃ padāgra-dvitayaṃ gṛhītvā*** ।
> ***jānūpari nyasta-śirāḥ samāno varteta yasyāṃ ravikoṭitejaḥ[1]*** ॥ ***41*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 41)**

- `prasārya` — absolutive — "having extended straight";
- `pādau` — accusative dual — "the two legs";
- `bhuvi` — locative singular — "on the ground";
- `daṇḍarūpau` — accusative dual — "straight like a staff";
- `dorbhyām` — instrumental dual — "with both arms";
- `padāgra-dvitayam` — accusative singular — "the pair of foot-tips (toes)";
- `gṛhītvā` — absolutive — "having grasped";
- `jānūpari` — adverbial compound — "upon the knees";
- `nyasta-śirāḥ` — bahuvrīhi, nominative singular — "having rested the head";
- `samānaḥ` — nominative singular — "being balanced / activating samāna-vāyu";
- `varteta` — verb, optative middle, 3rd person singular — "let him remain";
- `yasyām` — relative pronoun feminine locative — "in which [posture]";
- `ravikoṭitejaḥ` [ravi-koṭi-tejas-] — bahuvrīhi compound, masculine, nominative singular (compound: `ravi` ["sun"] + `koṭi` ["ten million"] + `tejas` ["splendor, fire"]) — "possessing the blazing splendor of ten million suns".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 42)**

> इति पश्चिमततानमासनं स्यादाशनैः प्राणमरुद्गतेः प्रवेशम्[1] ।
> जठराग्निविवर्धनं क्षमायां ददते जानुकरे शिरस् समानम्[2] ॥ ४२ ॥

**IAST (Verse 42)**

> ***iti paścimatānam āsanaṃ syād aśanaiḥ prāṇamarudgateḥ praveśam[1]*** ।
> ***jaṭharāgni-vivardhanaṃ kṣamāyāṃ dadate jānukare śiras-samānam[2]*** ॥ ***42*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 42)**

- `iti` — particle — "thus";
- `paścimatānam` [paścima-tāna-] — nominative singular (compound: `paścima` ["posterior / back channel, suṣumnā"] + `tāna` ["stretching"]) — "Posterior Stretch (paścimatāna)";
- `āsanam` — nominative singular — "posture";
- `syāt` — optative — "is";
- `aśanaiḥ` [in «b» *anilapravāham*] — adverb in «a» / in «b» "flow of breath";
- `prāṇamarudgateḥ` — genitive/ablative singular — "of the movement of the prāṇa breath";
- `praveśam` — accusative singular — "entrance [into suṣumnā]";

- `jaṭharāgni-vivardhanam` — compound adjective — "powerfully stimulating the gastric fire";
- `kṣamāyām` — locative singular — "upon the earth";
- `dadate` — verb, present middle, 3rd person singular — "it grants";
- `jānukare` — locative singular — "at the knees and hands";
- `śiras-samānam` — accusative singular — "leveling of the head [with knees]".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 43)**

> इति पश्चिमततानं स्यादासनेषूत्तमं भवेत्[३] ।
> दरमन्दस्य वह्नेश्च दीपनं वातनाशनम्[४] ॥ ४३ ॥

**IAST (Verse 43)**

> ***iti paścimatānaṃ syād āsaneṣv uttamaṃ bhavet[३]*** ।
> ***dara-mandasya vahneś ca dīpanaṃ vātanāśanam[४]*** ॥ ***43*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 43)**

- `iti` — particle — "thus";
- `paścimatānam` — nominative singular — "Paścimatāna";
- `syāt` — optative — "is";
- `āsaneṣu` — locative plural — "among āsanas";
- `uttamam` — superlative adjective — "the foremost, supreme";
- `bhavet` — optative — "is";
- `dara-mandasya` [in «b» *jara-mandasya*] — genitive singular (compound: `dara` ["slightly, dimmed"] + `manda` ["sluggish, weak"]) — "of the feeble, sluggish fire";
- `vahneḥ` — genitive singular — "of the fire";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `dīpanam` — noun/adjective — "kindling, blazing forth";
- `vātanāśanam` — compound adjective — "destroyer of vāta disorders".

**Colophon after Verse 43**:

> इति पश्चिमततानासनम् ।
> ***iti paścimatānāsanam .***
> **"Thus concludes Paścimatānāsana."**

**Literal Translation (Verses 41–43)**

Having extended the two legs on the ground straight like a staff, having grasped the two toes with both hands, with head resting upon the knees, balanced, let him remain in that posture possessing the splendor of ten million suns. Thus Paścimatāna is the posture causing the entrance of the movement of the prāṇa breath [into the central channel], kindling the gastric fire, when the head is leveled with the knees upon the ground. Thus Paścimatāna is supreme among postures, kindling the dimmed digestive fire and destroying vāta.

**Literary Translation (Verses 41–43)**

Stretching both legs out upon the earth, straight and unbending like a wooden staff, the yogin grasps his toes with both hands and rests his forehead against his knees. Resting balanced in this posture, he radiates with the blazing solar brilliance of ten million suns!

This is Paścimatāna («the Posterior Stretch Pose»); it forces the current of the vital breath straight into the central suṣumnā channel, dramatically intensifies the digestive fire of the belly, and levels the spine into perfect harmony.

Paścimatāna is celebrated as the foremost among all physical postures: it reignites the dying embers of the gastric fire and thoroughly eradicates every affliction born of aggravated vāta.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 41**: In «a», the grand solar metaphor `varteta yasyāṃ ravikoṭitejaḥ` ("radiating with the luster of ten million suns"); «b» replaces this with an empty phrase: `varteta hyeṣā bhavatīti śaṃsaḥ`.
- **Footnotes to Verse 42**: In «b», the line is harmonized with *Haṭhapradīpikā* 1.29; «a» preserves Sundaradeva's genuine original phrasing.
- **Footnote 4 to Verse 43**: In «a», `dara-mandasya` ("slightly sluggish / dimmed fire"); «b» misreads this as `jara-mandasya` ("sluggish from old age") due to scribal confusion between Devanāgarī *da* and *ja*.

## 15. SVASTIKĀSANA (AUSPICIOUS POSE, VERSES 44–45)

**Devanāgarī (Verse 44)**

> जानूर्वोरन्तरे सम्यक् कृत्वा पादतले उभे[1] ।
> ऋजुकायः समासीनः स्वस्तिकं तत् प्रचक्षते[2] ॥ ४४ ॥

**IAST (Verse 44)**

> ***jānūrvor antare samyak kṛtvā pādātale ubhe[1]*** ।
> ***ṛjukāyaḥ samāsīnaḥ svastikaṃ tat pracakṣate[2]*** ॥ ***44*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 44)**

- `jānūrvoḥ` — genitive/locative dual — "of the knees and thighs";
- `antare` — locative postposition — "between, in the space between";
- `samyak` — adverb — "properly, snugly";
- `kṛtvā` — absolutive — "having placed";
- `pādātale` — noun, neuter, accusative dual (in «a» with lengthened vowel; «b» *pādatale*) — "the two soles of the feet";
- `ubhe` — numeral, neuter, accusative dual (in «b» masculine *ubhau*) — "both";
- `ṛjukāyaḥ` [ṛju-kāya-] — bahuvrīhi, masculine, nominative singular — "holding the torso straight and erect";
- `samāsīnaḥ` — present middle participle from root `ās` ["to sit"], nominative singular — "seated firmly";
- `svastikam` — noun, neuter, nominative singular — "Auspicious Pose (svastikāsana)";
- `tat` — demonstrative pronoun — "that";
- `pracakṣate` — verb, present middle 3rd person plural — "they declare, authorities call".

**Devanāgarī (Verse 45)**

> एतत् स्वस्तिकमासनं निगदितं प्राणस्य सन्धानदं
> सर्वक्लेशहरं सदा सुखकरं योगीश्वरैः संस्तुतम्[3] ।
> यान्ति व्याधिगणाः क्षयं क्षणवशात् तस्याभ्यासतो निर्मला
> दीप्तिः स्याज् जठरालये च परमा शान्तिः सदा देहिनाम् ॥ ४५ ॥

**IAST (Verse 45)**

> ***etat svastikam āsanaṃ nigaditaṃ prāṇasya saṃdhānadaṃ***
> ***sarvakleśaharaṃ sadā sukhakaraṃ yogīśvaraiḥ saṃstutam[3]*** ।
> ***yānti vyādhigaṇāḥ kṣayaṃ kṣaṇavaśāt tasyābhyāsato nirmalā***
> ***dīptiḥ syāj jaṭharālaye ca paramā śāntiḥ sadā dehinām*** ॥ ***45*** ॥

**Word-by-Word Grammatical Analysis (Verse 45)**

- `etat` — demonstrative pronoun — "this";
- `svastikam āsanam` — nominative singular — "Svastika posture (svastikāsana)";

- `nigaditam` — past passive participle — "declared";
- `prāṇasya` — genitive singular — "of the vital breath (prāṇa)";
- `saṃdhānadam` — compound adjective — "bestowing integration and union";
- `sarvakleśaharam` — compound adjective — "destroying all afflictions (kleśas)";
- `sadā` — adverb — "always";
- `sukhakaram` — compound adjective — "generating comfort and bliss";
- `yogīśvaraiḥ` — instrumental plural of agent — "by the lords of yogins";
- `saṃstutam` — past passive participle — "extolled, praised";
- `yānti` — verb, present active 3rd person plural — "they go";
- `vyādhigaṇāḥ` — noun, masculine, nominative plural — "the hosts of diseases";
- `kṣayam` — accusative singular — "to destruction, to extinction";
- `kṣaṇavaśāt` — ablative of cause — "in the power of an instant, immediately";
- `tasya` — genitive singular — "of its";
- `abhyāsataḥ` — ablative noun — "from regular practice";
- `nirmalā` — adjective, feminine, nominative singular — "pure, spotless";
- `dīptiḥ` — noun, feminine, nominative singular — "radiance, blazing light";
- `syāt` — optative — "bursts forth, blazes";
- `jaṭharālaye` — locative singular — "in the hearth of the belly (in the stomach)";
- `ca` — conjunction — "and";
- `paramā` — adjective, feminine, nominative singular — "supreme";
- `śāntiḥ` — noun, feminine, nominative singular — "peace, tranquil liberation";
- `sadā` — adverb — "eternally";
- `dehinām` — noun, masculine, genitive plural — "of embodied beings".

**Final Colophon of Chapter 7**:

> इति श्रीमद्गोविन्ददेवसूनुसुन्दरदेवसंगृहीतायां हठतत्त्वकौमुद्यामासनानि नाम सप्तमोऽध्यायः ॥
>
> ***iti śrīmad-govindadeva-sūnu-sundaradeva-saṃgṛhītāyāṃ haṭhatattvakaumudyām āsanāni nāma saptamo 'dhyāyaḥ*** ॥
>
> **"Thus in the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, compiled by the venerable Sundaradeva, son of the noble Govindadeva, concludes the seventh chapter entitled «Teaching on Āsanas»."**

**Literal Translation (Verses 44–45)**

Having placed properly both soles of the feet between the knees and thighs, seated with the body erect, that they call Svastika. This posture Svastika is declared by the lords of yogins as bestowing integration of the prāṇa, destroying all afflictions, always producing bliss, and praised by the masters. From its practice hosts of diseases go to destruction in an instant, a pure light blazes in the hearth of the belly, and supreme peace eternally abides for embodied beings.

**Literary Translation (Verses 44–45)**

Tucking the soles of both feet neatly into the creases between the thighs and calves of the opposite legs, the yogin sits with an upright, perfectly erect spine. Masters of yoga proclaim this stable posture to be Svastikāsana («the Auspicious Pose»).

This blessed Svastikāsana is exalted by the supreme lords of yoga: it bestows total integration upon the vital prāṇic currents, uproots all bodily and spiritual afflictions (*kleśas*), and continually radiates sublime peace and joy.

Through its faithful practice, hosts of diseases are annihilated in a single instant; a pure, radiant flame ignites within the furnace of the belly; and supreme, everlasting peace settles into the hearts of embodied beings.

**Textological Commentary and Critical Apparatus**

- **Footnote 1 to Verse 44**: In «a», neuter dual `pādātale ubhe`; «b» introduces masculine `ubhau` with neuter noun, a grammatical gender mismatch.
- **Footnote 2 to Verse 44**: In «a», the canonical `tat pracakṣate`; «b» substitutes `samudāhṛtam`.
- **Footnote 3 to Verse 45**: In «a», neuter participle `saṃstutam` correctly agrees with *āsanam*; «b» gives masculine `saṃstutaḥ`. Witness «a» is syntactically pristine.

## SECTION III. COMPREHENSIVE COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS TABLE OF THE 15 ĀSANAS

| № | Āsana Name (IAST) | Sanskrit Name | Verses | Key Biomechanical Dominant | Pathophysiological and Therapeutic Efficacy according to Sundaradeva |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Dhanurāsana** | धनुरासनम् | 5 | Seizing toes with hands and pulling leg back toward the ear like an archer's bowstring | Purification of subtle energetic channels (*nāḍīśuddhi*), opening of pelvic joints, expansion of thoracic cavity |
| 2 | **Kukkuṭāsana** | कुक्कुटासनम् | 6 | Threading arms between thighs and calves in Padmāsana; balancing aloft on palms | Strengthens pectoral and shoulder girdle; creates deep core abdominal compression; stimulates visceral digestive fire |
| 3 | **Matsyendrapīṭha** | मत्स्येन्द्रपीठम् | 7–8 | Deep spiral spinal rotation with foot placed against the opposite thigh base | Shatters host of fierce diseases like a divine missile; fans *jaṭharāgni*; awakens *kuṇḍalinī*; preserves lunar nectar (*amṛta*) |
| 4 | **Mayūrāsana** | मयूरासनम् | 9–10 | Balancing on elbows pressed beside the navel; body extended horizontally like a staff | Cures spleen tumors (*gulma*) and dropsy (*udara*); subdues vitiated *doṣas*; incinerates indiscriminate food and digests lethal *kālakūṭa* poison |
| 5 | **Śavāsana** | शवासनम् | 11–13 | Complete supine relaxation on the floor like an unmoving corpse | Instantly dissolves spasmodic *vātagaṇḍa* (vātic knots/tumors) in |

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| | | | | | the chest; dispels systemic exhaustion; readies body for *prāṇāyāma* |
| 6 | **Siṃhāsana** | सिंहासनम् | 14–16 | Ankles crossed beneath scrotum; hands on knees; jaws agape; gazing at nose-tip (*nāsāgradṛṣṭi*) | Subdues aggravated *vāta*; induces spontaneous synergistic engagement of the three locks (*mūla-*, *uḍḍīyāna-*, *jālandhara-bandha*) |
| 7 | **Bhadrāsana** | भद्रासनम् | 17 | Soles joined beneath scrotum beside perineum; hands firmly clasping feet | Eradicates all diseases; purges endogenous toxic metabolic waste; pacifies aggravated *kapha* and *vāta* |
| 8 | **Vīrāsana** | वीरासनम् | 18–19 | One foot placed upon opposite thigh near knee with spine held perfectly vertical | Bestows fulfillment of all desires (*sarvakāmaprada*); builds resolute fortitude (*dhṛti*); prepares mind for contemplating the *Ātman* and gaining *jñāna* |
| 9 | **Kūrmāsana** | कूर्मासनम् | 20 | Ankles crossed and pressed firmly against the anal sphincter | Radically cures all 80 classical disorders of the *vāta* humor (*sarvavātarugāpaha*) by regulating *apāna-vāyu* |
| 10 | **Prasāritāsana** | प्रसारितासनम् | 21 | Legs extended wide and flat upon the floor; hands grasping feet | Stretches posterior myofascial and meridian lines; establishes an unshakable foundation for advanced *Rāja Yoga* |
| 11 | **Padmāsana** | पद्मासनम् | 22–28 | Feet crossed soles-upward on opposite thighs; hands cupped; *nabhomudrā*; *jālandharabandha* | Destroys all diseases; dynamically balances *prāṇa* and *apāna* (reversing apāna upward and prāṇa downward); forces |

| | | | | | |
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| | | | | | vital breath into *suṣumnā* |
| 12 | **Baddhapadmāsana** | बद्धपद्मासनम् | 29–32 | Cross-locking hands behind the back to clasp opposite big toes in Padmāsana | Conquers chronic mixed fevers of *vāta* and *kapha* (*vātakaphajvarāpaha*); eliminates deep-seated toxins; corroborated by *Yogacandrikā* |
| 13 | **Siddhāsana / Yonyāsana** | सिद्धासनम् / योन्यासनम् | 33–40 | Heel pressed into perineum (*yonisthāna*); upper heel above pubic bone; *śāmbhavī*- or *nāsāgradṛṣṭi* | Queen of all āsanas (peerless like the holy Gaṅgā among rivers); absolves all sins without need for strenuous *śīrṣāsana*; grants mastery in 1 year |
| 14 | **Paścimatānāsana** | पश्चिमाता Liberator | 41–43 | Seated forward bend with legs extended; forehead resting on knees; toes clasped | Forces breath into *suṣumnā*; endows yogin with splendor of 10 million suns; reignites extinguished gastric fire; eradicates *vāta* |
| 15 | **Svastikāsana** | स्वस्तिकासनम् | 44–45 | Soles tucked symmetrically between opposite thighs and calves with upright spine | Integrates vital currents (*prāṇasya saṃdhānadam*); instantly destroys hosts of diseases; kindles visceral belly flame; grants eternal peace |